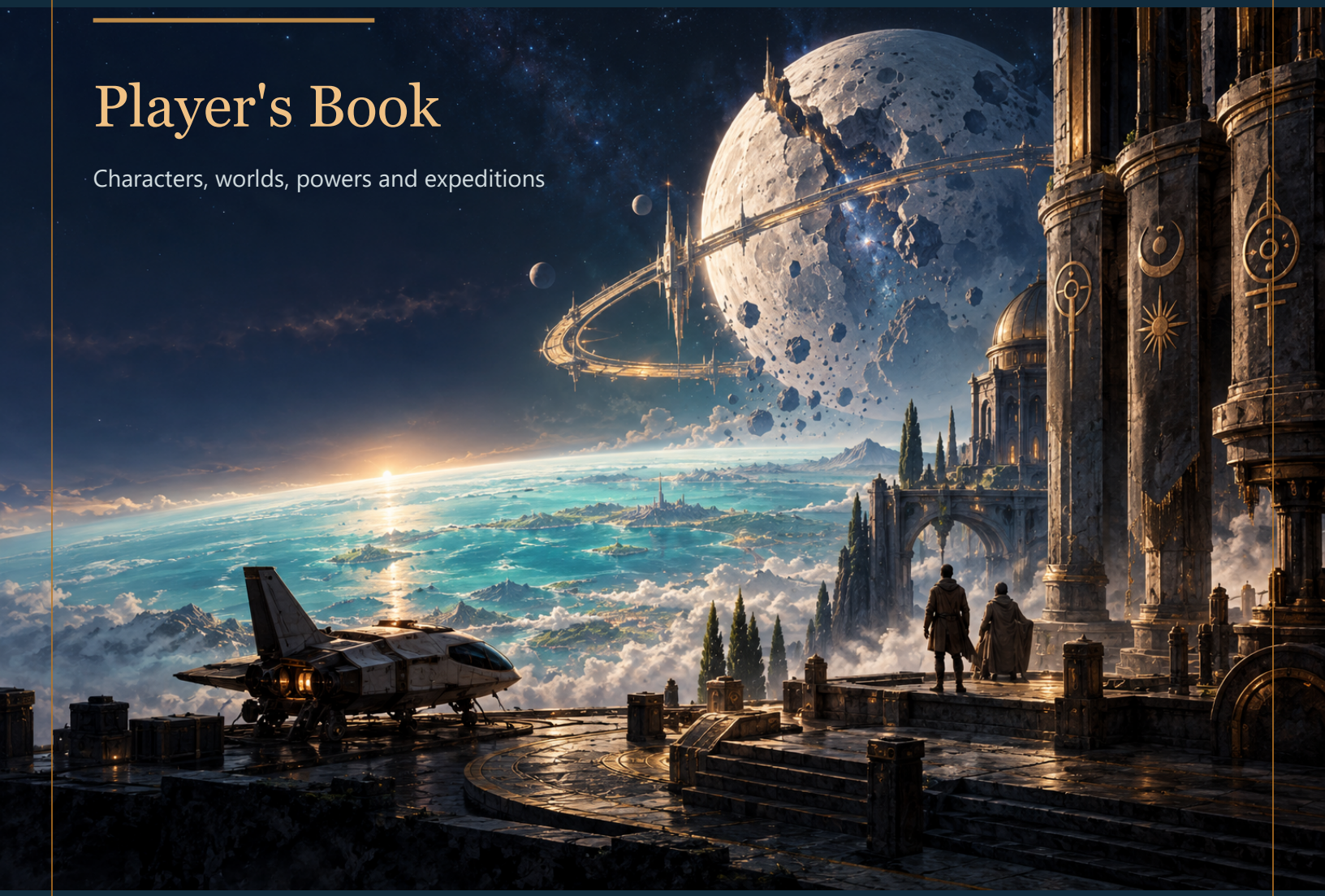
A SPACE-FANTASY ROLEPLAYING GAME

LANTERN REACH

Player's Book

Characters, worlds, powers and expeditions



CORE / ALPHA 0.3.1 / PLAYTEST EDITION

An original space-fantasy adventure RPG.
Pantheons. Strange worlds. A crew of your own.

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Using this book

This is an original space-fantasy roleplaying game for two to four players and one Guide. A duet option supports one player and one Guide. Use two ordinary six-sided dice, paper and tokens; miniatures and the offline companion are optional.

For first play, choose a ready explorer and shared ship, read Core rules, and let the Guide prepare The Silent Berth. For a custom character begin with Pantheon, Lineage, Embodiment, Provenance, Vocation and a personal Creed; Discipline opens at rank 2.

The default campaign follows a crew with a ship: travel, strange worlds, civilizations, dangerous encounters, artifacts and personal quests. Pantheons matter to identity, powers and daily life. Zeal is restrained and contextual; territorial management is an optional campaign module.

Species, bodily nature, upbringing, profession, specialization and religion are separate choices. Humans include many factions, beliefs and ways of existing. Nothing requires one species or body to follow a particular Pantheon.

The numbered rule chapters preserve the manuscript numbering across both books. Chapters 04 and 11 belong to the Guide's Book; the other numbered chapters belong to the Player's Book. Setting and play-aid sections are separately labeled. Blue internal references link to a chapter when it is in this volume.

Manifest Destiny / Rise of the Zealots provide inspiration, not a requirement to reproduce their source world. Original Lantern Reach figures, peoples and places develop independently; source-game characters are not silently rewritten.

This alpha has editorial checks, mathematical analysis and tested software aids. It has not completed external live tabletop playtests and does not claim proven balance or the breadth of established commercial games. The repository contains the editable source, development notes and playtest record.

Readiness and ownership

Players own their characters' beliefs and choices. Agree on tone before play and pause when needed. No rule forces religious conviction, personal disclosure or one predetermined solution to a scene. A Guide gives concrete opportunities and consequences, then lets the crew choose its route.

Start / Your first voyage

You are a crew of spacefaring adventurers. You have a ship, useful skills, personal reasons to travel and a relationship with one of three Pantheons. You might be a pilgrim, soldier, scholar, engineer, explorer or several of those at once. Choose where to go, meet people, investigate strange places and decide what to do when plans go wrong.

Five-minute start

1. Choose a ready explorer. For a first session, the six sheets already contain legal attributes, body features, skills and powers. Change name, appearance, home or relationships freely. Custom builds can wait until you have seen the rules work.
2. Read your Vocation talent, one starting technique, Pantheon affinity and two rites. You don't need to memorize the other characters' abilities or future ranks.
3. Name the shared Courier. Start Hull **8/8**, Stores **4/6**, Supply **4/8**, Accord **2/3**, and Sanctuary berth module. Decide why you trust this crew enough to leave port together.
4. Each character starts Guard **6**, Strain **0/4**, Conviction **2/3**, light armor unused, no wounds, communicator and sealed excursion suit. Most ordinary weapons deal **2** damage.
5. Let the Guide offer the station rescue, a survey job or another reachable lead. Ask what success means, what is known about the danger and what the payment/commitment is. Then choose.

What you say

Describe intent and approach: “I want to get the passengers into shelter; I can repair the lift,” or “I want the guard to let us inspect the cargo; I offer to take responsibility for the escort.” Ask questions. You can negotiate, use tools, move, fight, help someone or try something the rulebook didn't anticipate.

The Guide gives obvious facts freely. A roll is for uncertainty with consequences, not for permission to notice a visible door. Before rolling, know the effect and risk. A useful offer may work without a roll. An impossible act needs a changed situation rather than lucky dice.

Your roll

Roll **2d6 + attribute**, sometimes **+1 for one relevant expertise**, and at most one net situational **-1/0/+1**. Ordinary weapon strikes/physical defense don't get a generic expertise bonus. Help, cover and many powers share the same situation slot.

Total	What happens
6 or less	Your intent fails and the stated consequence happens
7-9	Your intent succeeds with its stated cost or reduced effect
10-11	Full success
12+	Full success plus one exceptional benefit: +1 damage/progress, avoid an immediate hazard, or next ally edge

For an extended task, success fills **1 / 2 / 3** progress respectively; failure fills none and changes the situation. The third progress already includes the exceptional benefit. Spend 1 shared Accord after a roll to reroll both dice once; keep the new result.

During danger

Personal encounters alternate one crew activation and one enemy activation; choose which ally goes next. Your turn gives one move to an adjacent zone and one action. Sprint uses the action for another move. Move, strike, Help, interact, use a power or work the objective. Brief speech is free; resolving a difficult negotiation isn't.

A close strike uses Force, a ranged strike Finesse, with specific class exceptions such as Kinetic Bolt. Partial strike deals damage but gives you 1 Strain or exposure; miss gives no damage and 1 Strain. Against an enemy attack **you** defend with Force/Finesse: miss takes damage, partial takes full damage or half rounded up plus 1 Strain, full success avoids it. NPCs don't also roll an attack.

If you reach Strain 4, reset it to 1 and choose withdrawal through your next turn or lose 2 Guard. At Guard 0 you're Downed; an ally can stabilize you with an action. Wounds and retirement follow the core rules. Ask for retreat, rescue, surrender or another route when the fight is going badly. Winning a mission doesn't require defeating every opponent.

Three examples

A useful offer: Esra proposes supervised access while Cal inspects the station. Quill's actual need is assurance about her salvage claim. If the proposal meets it, she agrees-no ritual, conversion or roll required.

A task under pressure: Cal repairs a coolant manifold with Insight +2 and Machinery +1. Dice 2 and 3 yield total 8: a costly success. The scenario offers 1 Power progress without another cost, or 2 progress by spending 1 Supply. Cal chooses progress 1, preserving supplies. Taren can brace the system while others help or evacuate.

A protected hit: a guard attacks Taren for 2 damage. Taren rolls defense total 8 and chooses half damage (1) plus 1 Strain. Taren spends the unused light-armor reduction to prevent that remaining 1 damage. Guard stays 6, Strain rises to 1, armor is marked used. There is no continuous-armor minimum applied after that limited reduction.

These are authored examples of the rules, not records of actual playtests.

Between scenes and worlds

Push before rolling: pay 1 activation Strain for +1 damage to one target or +1 task progress on success. It changes effect, not dice. Add all activation Strain together and resolve Fracture before acting; interruption or a miss still spends the cost.

Brief observance: ten peaceful minutes, once/expedition, restore Conviction to 3. A religious or secular practice can express your Creed. Once/scene, a meaningful voluntary cost for that commitment can also restore 1 Conviction; routine activation costs alone do not qualify.

One safe ten-minute group Recovery costs 1 Supply and restores 3 Guard, clears 2 Strain, and restores Conviction to at least 2. Sanctuary berth can make one safe onboard Recovery per expedition free. A new room doesn't refresh a scene's powers. Safe sleep restores health/stress but doesn't erase wounds or refill Accord.

Each travel leg costs 1 ship Stores. At a supplier, 1 Supply buys 1 Stores. Routine flight is usually narrated; a risky route is a meaningful choice. In a ship encounter every PC operates one station, then the opponent ship/group takes one action-different from personal initiative.

After an adventure, choose downtime, follow a personal question and collect the actual reward. At rank 2 choose a Discipline and novice elective; later choices can wait. A religious observance, a new body, a technical discovery or an old friend can all matter. The next adventure belongs to the crew's choices.

The core rules, table reference and offline companion provide the details when you need them.

01 / Core rules

The table

One Guide presents the world and adjudicates consequences. Two to four players portray a spacefaring crew: explorers, fighters, pilgrims, scholars, salvagers and adventurers. For one player see the duet rules. Play alternates between conversation, exploration, risky actions, tactical scenes and downtime aboard ship. Use ordinary d6s; a token represents one character or a small squad. A Pantheon gives the adventure spiritual identity; a mission need not involve religion or Zeal to matter.

Before play agree on the tone, excluded subjects and how to pause or fade a scene. Religious coercion is a theme, not permission to coerce players. Any player may pause. Never require personal religious disclosures.

Time and refresh limits

A **turn** is one character's activation; a **round** ends after all eligible characters on both sides have activated. A **scene** is a continuous situation with a meaningful objective and pressure: the whole gate negotiation, reactor repair, or running fight. Moving to the next room, waiting a minute, repeating an introduction, or briefly leaving combat does not create a fresh scene. The Guide announces a scene transition when the objective/pressure substantially changes or meaningful downtime intervenes. Once/scene abilities refresh at that transition, not by naming another task. A paid Recovery is available once after that scene's immediate danger ends; it does not create another scene by itself.

A **session** is a real play meeting; ending a scene does not refresh once/session powers. A **watch** is four fictional hours. An **expedition** starts when the crew leaves a safe port/refuge on a job or exploration and ends when it returns to a safe base and concludes or abandons that undertaking. Multiple landings or pauses on the same outing do not refresh once/expedition modules. At an agreed major change of mission in the field, the Guide may begin a new expedition only after genuine safe resupply/downtime. State this before refreshing resources.

Rules language: a specific feature can override a general rule explicitly. An **ally** is another willing character; a **willing target** may include yourself unless the effect says ally/enemy or requires another position. The player can consent to a beneficial effect on a Downed character, but ordinary healing/revival limits still apply. Guide-run NPCs don't roll; player-controlled companions, retinue or drones use their stated player-roll rules. Establish legal targets and available costs before activating a power. A scene's ordinary turn is enough time for a meaningful move and action, not a fixed universal number of seconds; ship rounds may represent longer maneuvers than personal rounds.

Character identity: Pantheon -> Lineage -> Embodiment -> Provenance -> Vocation -> Creed

Choose a **Pantheon** first: your relationship with a family of sacred powers and traditions. It supplies an affinity, two starting rites and a growth path. Choose a **Lineage**, your species or inherited bodily nature, independently of your beliefs. Choose a **Provenance**, the homeworld environment and community that formed you. Choose a **Vocation**, your practical way of confronting danger. Write a **Creed**, a personal principle that need not be religious. None determines morality or compulsory obedience. Any Lineage can follow any Pantheon and any Vocation.

Creation

1. Choose Order, Ancients or Divinity in chapter 2 and one of its two Aspects. Record its affinity and two starting rites. Names are drawn from current game presentation; the tabletop packages are proposals. Devotion, cultural affiliation, doubt and dissent are all playable relationships.

2. Assign +2, +1, +1, 0 to **Force** (endure, strike, carry), **Finesse** (move, aim, conceal), **Insight** (notice, reason, repair), **Presence** (lead, negotiate, channel).
3. Choose a Lineage and an Embodiment and record both packages from Lineages and equipment. Choose a Provenance below and name the world, station or ship where you grew up. Provenance grants one expertise and a contact. An expertise adds +1 to an applicable roll. At most one expertise applies to a roll. New homeworld details are table-created setting additions.
4. Choose a Vocation from chapter 2. Record its starting talent, your choice of one starting technique from Vocation paths, and equipment.
5. Write a Creed: "I will ___, even when ___; I will never ___." Name someone you protect and one thing you doubt. No intentionally trivial obligations: the group must identify a plausible cost.
6. Record rank 1; **Guard 6**, **Strain 0/4**, **Conviction 2/3**. Choose a basic weapon (damage 2, close or ranged) and light armor (one use per scene to reduce an incoming hit by 1). Carry three personal items, food and water, a communicator, sealed excursion suit and your Vocation kit. No inventory weight accounting unless carrying something implausible.
7. As a group choose one shared bond, **Supply 4/8**, and **Accord 2/3**. Choose a ship from travel and ships; ship Stores are separate from Supply. All protagonists know why they are working together before the opening scene. Take a job, expedition or personal quest. A ship may be owned jointly, borrowed or owed to a patron; its debt creates an adventure hook, not automatic recurring taxes.

Provenances

These describe upbringing independently of Lineage. Name a homeworld or community and one custom, food, festival or ordinary pastime you remember. These details give places life without creating new combat bonuses.

Provenance	Expertise	Contact who can help once per adventure
Foundry-Raised	Machinery	Mechanic: repair a device without a roll if given an hour
Road-Bound	Routes	Courier: reveal one safe route and its real cost
Void-Born	Spacecraft	Deckhand: provide access to a routine dock or one ordinary ship component
Sanctuary-Kept	Care	Attendant: provide shelter for one recovery
Border-Forged	Watchfulness	Scout: reveal the nearest immediate threat
Archive-Taught	Records	Clerk: obtain one ordinary local record
Unhoused	Improvisation	Neighbor: hide the group for one scene

Contacts cannot erase an active pursuit without a scene; their listed help is guaranteed if reachable and not already endangered by established events. The Guide gives a way to reach each contact during preparation.

Expertise has a purpose, not a passive aura. Machinery applies to repair, device operation and technical understanding; Routes to finding/traversing a route; Spacecraft to ship handling and systems; Care to treatment and physical well-being; Watchfulness to detecting or interpreting observable threats; Records to documents/research; Improvisation to making a useful changed tool or approach. Merely being aboard a ship doesn't add Spacecraft to every roll, and noticing an enemy doesn't add Watchfulness to every attack or defense. Ordinary weapon strikes and physical defenses use their attribute

without a generic expertise bonus. A specific feature may say otherwise. A technical sabotage task can use Machinery; a separate weapon strike exploiting its result uses an earned edge rather than also claiming Machinery by target type.

For the proposed Lantern Reach setting, each PC speaks their home/community language and shared trade speech, using a speech aid or text interface if preferred. Additional languages follow biography, not an attribute tax. Unfamiliar languages can create research or first-contact scenes; do not prevent a mixed-species starting crew from communicating.

Resolution

Roll only when there is uncertainty and a meaningful consequence. State intent, attribute, expertise, effect and risk before rolling. Roll **2d6 + attribute + expertise**, then apply at most one situational edge or hindrance (+1 or -1). Net all edges and hindrances into that single modifier. Attribute maximum +3. No other bonus stacking.

Total	Outcome
6 or less	Intent fails; stated consequence happens
7-9	Intent succeeds with the stated cost or reduced effect; player chooses between the two if both are offered
10-11	Intent succeeds at full stated effect
12+	Full success and choose: +1 damage/progress, avoid one immediate hazard, or give the next ally +1 on their next roll this scene

No critical failure on particular faces. Impossible actions need a changed situation, not a higher target. Automatic actions need no roll. A failed attempt changes the situation; another identical roll requires a new approach, tool or cost.

Pressure: for extended tasks draw a 4-segment clock (short), 6 (major) or 8 (session-scale). A risky success fills 1, full success 2, exceptional success 3; failure fills none and invokes the announced consequence. The third segment already includes the exceptional progress benefit; choose another exceptional benefit instead only by taking 2 progress. A reduced-effect result fills 1 without another cost. Do not use both clocks and Guard for the same obstacle unless they represent different objectives.

Push: make the moment count

Before rolling a **personal strike, damaging hostile rite or task-clock action**, you may **Push**: add **1 activation Strain** to gain **+1 damage to one target or +1 progress on that task if the action succeeds**. Choose damage or progress before rolling. This changes effect, not the dice modifier. A normal pushed task therefore fills 2/3/4 on partial/full/exceptional success, before any explicitly offered alternative partial cost. If you choose another exceptional benefit instead of exceptional progress, take the full-success progress plus Push: 3.

One Push per action. It uses the action you were already taking, not another action. Pay the Strain even on a miss. Add it to all other activation Strain for that payer, including overreach, and resolve Fracture **before** the roll. Withdrawal or becoming Downed interrupts the action with costs spent; losing 2 Guard while remaining able lets you continue. Partial/miss result costs still happen after the roll. An Accord reroll keeps the same Push with no additional activation payment; apply the final effect once.

Push can combine with a legal weapon, talent, rite or exceptional benefit; it never adds another target or attack. It does not enhance healing, temporary Guard, movement, defense, automatic actions, clocks already complete or ship-station actions. A damaging rite with several targets adds the damage to only the one chosen target. A control strike replacing all damage cannot convert that replaced damage into progress on another objective. Resolve armor and other reductions after building the final damage normally.

Example: at Strain 2, a carbine user Pushes to 3 before rolling. A full success deals 3 instead of 2 damage. A partial deals that damage but still requires Strain or exposure; choosing Strain now triggers Fracture after the hit. The player can take a larger risk without needing a particular class, and can instead choose an ordinary shot to preserve capacity.

Help: spend your action in a tactical scene, or expose yourself to the same consequence outside it, to give one ally an edge on their next relevant roll. It expires at the end of their next turn in rounds, or after the next risky group action outside rounds. Describe useful help; repeating useless help does not create a bonus. **Opposed aims:** PCs roll against the risk posed by NPCs; NPCs never roll. Between willing PCs, both roll; higher succeeds, tie preserves the status quo. A disagreement cannot force belief, romance or consent.

Action and trigger order

1. Establish a legal action, targets, effect, available costs and risk.
2. Pay activation costs, including any overreach. For one activation, sum its Strain costs per payer and apply that total as one packet; then resolve each payer's resulting Fracture once before continuing. Withdrawal or becoming Downed interrupts the unresolved action with costs spent. Separate result costs happen later in step 5.
3. Roll, or apply an automatic effect if no roll is needed.
4. Before resolving the outcome, use any feature explicitly allowed after seeing the dice, such as a Witness edge, and optionally one Accord reroll. Recalculate the band with legal modifiers. A before-roll Conviction edge must have been paid before the first roll; it can't be bought retroactively without a specific feature.
5. Choose the allowed outcome/cost option, apply its effect and result costs, and resolve any resulting Fracture. A partial-cost substitution must be paid now, before an after-resolution refund.
6. Apply after-resolution triggers/refunds, then check the scene's objective or countdown timing. A specific feature can state a different order, such as Luminous Intercession resolving its Strain after saving the ally.

An Accord reroll is the **same action**, not a new attempt or free resource refresh. Already committed modifiers/activation costs remain. It replaces both dice and the new result is kept. Only a genuinely changed approach or situation permits another separate attempt after a failure.

Conviction and Accord

Spend 1 Conviction before a roll for +1 (counts as the situational edge), or pay a rite cost. Once per scene, after voluntarily taking a meaningful material or social cost to uphold your Creed, regain 1 Conviction, maximum 3. The Guide and player identify the cost; self-inflicted trivial inconveniences do not count. Recovery restores Conviction to 2 only if currently below 2.

Make that opportunity concrete: state what you did, what it cost and which commitment it upheld. A Pantheon practice can express the Creed: Order keeps a promise when breaking it would be safer; Ancients preserves a person, record or living possibility at a real cost; Divinity shares a danger or opens a way someone could not take alone. Dissenters may challenge their own tradition. These are examples, not prescribed behavior. A nonreligious Creed qualifies equally. An ordinary activation cost, routine Push, repeated slogan or paid rite is not by itself a second qualifying sacrifice. All such claims share the same **one Conviction per scene** limit.

Once per expedition, **ten peaceful minutes of observance** restore your Conviction to 3. Name a familiar practice, religious or secular, in a genuinely safe place. This brief observance is not a downtime project and does not advance an emergency clock while pretending to happen between combat turns. It restores neither Guard, Strain nor wounds. Leaving a room, safe sleep or a new session does not renew the expedition use. Votary/Hierophant features retain their own broader scene/session opportunities.

An observance while preparing to depart counts against the forthcoming expedition. Begin that undertaking's record first, then mark the use; departure does not grant another recharge.

Spend 1 shared Accord after a roll to reroll both dice; keep the new result. One reroll per roll. Start each session with at least 2 Accord, retaining any higher value up to 3. Regain 1 Accord through one shared recovery per session: a negotiated sacrifice, a risky rescue outside the crew, or a willing crew scene about a new joint risk/discovery and how it changes trust or future intention. These share one limit, not one recovery each. See Between the stars for prompts. At Accord 3 the claim remains unused. Scenes, sleep and expeditions do not reset it; a new session does. Explicit features such as Legacy retain their own separate limits.

Tactical scenes

Use connected **zones**, each roughly a room, bridge span or small courtyard. Adjacent zones connect by an obvious traversable path. Close weapons affect your zone; ranged weapons affect your zone or an adjacent visible zone. A long-range position may reach two zones if a scenario explicitly grants it. Characters in a zone can reach each other unless separated by cover or a stated obstacle.

Each round **alternate one crew activation and one enemy activation** until everyone able to act has taken a turn. The crew chooses who activates next; the Guide chooses an unactivated enemy and states its action. Crew goes first in round 1 unless a clearly established ambush gives the enemies the opening; alternate the opening side each later round. If one side has no unactivated characters left, the other finishes its remaining turns. A Downed character cannot activate. A turn grants **one move to an adjacent zone and one action**, in either order. Sprint uses the action for another move. One reaction per character per round, only when an ability supplies one. No opportunity attacks. Enemies do not get extra turns as complications. Ship encounters use their separate crew-station/enemy-ship sequence in chapter 6.

Actions include strike, help, use a rite, interact, negotiate, or work an objective. Brief speech is free; convincing someone under fire is an action. An uncontested ordinary interaction is automatic; a dangerous objective uses the clock rules. Taking cover costs the action and lasts until you move or attack. For effects that end on attacking, an attack includes any rite aimed at an unwilling target.

Attacks and defense

A PC strike rolls Force for close or Finesse for ranged. On 7-9 deal weapon damage and choose either 1 Strain or exposure (+1 damage from the next enemy hit before your next turn). On 10+ deal weapon damage; on 12+ choose a normal exceptional benefit. On failure deal no damage and take 1 Strain. No immediate enemy counterattack. Enemy armor reduces damage by its rating; a hit always deals at least 1 after armor.

On an enemy turn, it moves and either attacks or uses one listed action. For an attack its target rolls Force to brace or Finesse to evade (must describe how). On 6- take listed damage; on 7-9 choose full damage or half damage rounded up plus 1 Strain; on 10+ avoid damage; on 12+ also move to an adjacent zone or give an ally an edge. **Only one PC defense roll per attack.** A PC in cover gets an edge to ranged defense. When a PC shoots an NPC in cover, the attack instead has one situational hindrance; do not roll a separate NPC defense. Cover ends when its user moves or attacks, for either side. Area effects, if listed, cause each target to defend separately.

Enemy profiles target only one character unless explicitly stated. PCs may take cover, flee, surrender, bargain or pursue the objective instead of exchanging hits. If all sides cease contesting the scene, tactical rounds end.

When an environmental hazard catches a Guide-run NPC, apply its listed ordinary damage/effect once unless an established protection/adaptation changes it. NPCs get the same visible warning and opportunity to leave a timed hazard; no extra NPC defense roll is added. A player-controlled companion or drone instead uses its stated defense rule.

Damage order

Build the hit's damage from its listed value plus any explicit bonus (including exposure or an exceptional strike). If the defender chooses a half-damage partial result, halve that total and round up. Apply continuous armor next: a positive damaging hit still deals at least 1 after that armor. Then apply limited reductions such as light armor, Bastion or a shared protection pool, down to 0. Finally spend temporary Guard before personal Guard. Temporary Guard is not healing and never revives a Downed person. Effects that deliberately deal no damage, such as suppression, never become damage-1 hits because of the armor minimum.

A successful incoming hit consumes exposure even if protection reduces its damage to 0; a fully avoided attack does not. Temporary Guard is at most 1 in this alpha, never stacks and expires at scene end. Separate named protections can combine unless their rules forbid it, but two copies of the same named protection never stack. Armor applies to damaging rites as well as weapons unless a specific effect says otherwise. A mundane locked door is not an armored creature that must be damaged one point at a time; use an interaction or task clock instead.

More than damage

Aim: spend an action lining up a target; gain an edge on your next ranged strike against it before the end of your next turn. Moving or losing sight cancels Aim. It does not stack above the situation cap. **Restrain/disarm:** make a Force or Finesse strike but replace all damage on success with dropping one held ordinary item in the target's zone, or pinning a human-scale target until your next turn. Pinning prevents zone movement; the target can spend its action escaping automatically, and can otherwise attack in its own zone. Partial/miss Strain still applies. Cannot restrain a ship or disarm an integrated body part. **Suppress:** use a ranged weapon and roll Finesse; on success deal no damage but one visible enemy cannot make a ranged attack on its next turn. It can take cover, move, use a rite or choose another action. Use normal strike partial/failure costs. Repeating suppression while it remains active does not extend it beyond one affected turn; the target gets a turn free of suppression afterward. These are optional actions available to all Vocations.

Harm and Strain

Guard represents your ability to remain effective through defense, endurance, positioning, near misses and immediate hurt. It isn't a literal count of bullets a body can absorb. **Wounds** track lasting harm after that defense breaks. **Strain** tracks the pressure of exertion, stress or overdriven powers; a mechanical or biological character may describe it differently while using the same rules.

Damage reduces Guard, minimum 0. At 0 Guard become **Downed**, unable to act, react or move unaided. An ally can stabilize you with an action in the same zone; no roll unless an external hazard interferes. Stabilized characters remain out until recovery. Ordinary Guard-healing abilities target conscious characters and don't revive the Downed; Recovery and features explicitly granting revival, such as Life Bridge, are exceptions. An unstabilized character gains one wound at the end of each following round; at three total wounds retire from the scene and choose with the player capture, lasting disability, or death. Death is never the automatic default.

Announce a deliberate attack on a Downed character early enough for allies to intervene. The Downed target can't make an ordinary defense roll or activate a new power, but existing passive protection applies. Resolve the hit's listed damage and reductions normally; if any damage remains, it adds **one wound instead of Guard damage**. If existing protection reduces it to 0, no wound is added. An intercepting ally can take the attack and defend as normal. Finishing an already defeated person is a deliberate enemy choice, not a free consequence after every failed roll.

Each wound reduces maximum Guard by 1, to a minimum maximum of 3. At most three wounds. A full day of safe care and 1 Supply removes one wound; ordinary recovery does not. A Downed PC gains one wound when stabilized, once per time Downed. Reaching three wounds from any cause triggers retirement from the scene as above. Retired PCs can return after care and an agreed consequence; a player may introduce a replacement at the crew's rank instead.

Retirement ends your participation in this scene: no actions, reactions or required channeling roles, even if a feature left you at positive Guard. Already resolved instant effects remain; effects needing your ongoing participation end. This makes Last Stand's three-wound consequence explicit rather than letting Guard 1 bypass it.

When Strain reaches or exceeds 4 suffer **Fracture**: reset Strain to 1 and choose to withdraw from the current exchange until the end of your next turn, or immediately lose 2 Guard. Withdrawal immediately ends any current action that has not yet resolved, prevents actions/reactions until its end, and allows ordinary movement toward safety on your next turn. Already resolved effects remain. If damage Downs you, apply Downed normally. Fracture never dictates belief or involuntary violence. Outside rounds withdrawal means sitting out the next risky group action. Your character does not gain involuntary religious convictions or a new personality from stress.

Recovery and gear

Once per scene after immediate danger ends, spend 10 minutes and 1 shared Supply for the whole group: restore 3 Guard each up to wounded maximum, reduce Strain by 2 (minimum 0), restore Conviction to at least 2. Stabilized PCs wake with that Guard. An uninterrupted safe night's rest restores Guard to wounded maximum, clears Strain and restores Conviction to at least 2 without Supply; it does not remove wounds or refill Accord. Rites cannot heal wounds unless explicitly stated.

Supply pays for abstract food, ammunition, common repairs and care. Ordinary attacks do not track ammunition. At Supply 0 recovery requires safe shelter and a night's rest; acquiring resources becomes an objective. Securing a modest cache gains 2 Supply, a major cache 4; never exceed 8. Trade useful salvage or perform a significant favor for 1-2 Supply as announced before committing. Ordinary weapons are damage 2; improvised weapons damage 1; bulky weapons damage 3 but you cannot move and use one on the same turn. Ranged weapons cannot shoot through an opaque obstruction.

Example

A courier with Finesse +2 crosses a damaged span under fire. The Guide says failure means falling into the lower route (1 damage and separated); a partial success means crossing but dropping the medicine or taking 1 Strain. A total 8 lets the courier cross and choose Strain. The player keeps the medicine. That action does not also roll against the rescue clock: crossing and delivering the medicine are separate fictional tasks.

02 / Pantheons, Creeds and Vocations

Pantheons lead character design

A **Pantheon** is an assembly of sacred powers, stories, institutions and contested interpretations. It determines which supernatural tools you begin with, how you form sacred bonds, and where your progression can lead. You may be devoted, doubtful, estranged or openly defiant while remaining entangled with it. No playable Pantheon is objectively the correct religion. Pantheons are a major character pillar; ordinary exploration, technology and martial skill remain equally legitimate ways to solve problems.

Three broad traditions shape life in the Reach: **Order**, with its works, promises and systems; **Ancients**, with memory, living relationships and change; and **Divinity**, with care, revelation and transformation. Each contains several schools and divine figures. Religious life describes practices and disagreements; gods and observances introduces the nine figures commonly honored in the region. Their stories give characters places to belong and questions to pursue.

Choose Pantheon, then an Aspect. Affinity is usable once per scene without Conviction and is automatic unless it says roll. Each Pantheon grants two starting rites; choose one additional rite from your own Pantheon at ranks 2 and 4. All players start equally capable of supernatural action; a skeptical character can interpret the effect as inherited practice or a phenomenon rather than devotion.

Pantheon / prototype package	Central question	Aspects (choose one)	Affinity
Order	When does protection become ownership?	Architect: build institutions; Dissenter: reclaim them	**Prepared Ground:** as an action place cover in your zone until scene end; it can protect anyone, including enemies
Ancients	What must change so something can endure?	Keeper: preserve relationships; Wanderer: carry them elsewhere	**Wayfinding:** as an action ask for the safest visible route to one reachable zone; the Guide reveals hazards and you may move one extra zone this turn
Divinity	Who pays for transcendence?	Lantern: make power visible; Threshold: guard what remains hidden	**Shared Breath:** as an action move up to 2 Strain from a willing ally in your zone to yourself; resolve Fracture normally

Aspect gives a story permission: access to a modest affiliated workshop (Architect), reform circle (Dissenter), caretaker (Keeper), waystation (Wanderer), public refuge (Lantern), or discreet messenger (Threshold). Once per adventure, if a settlement reasonably hosts such a contact, they offer ordinary shelter or one truthful lead without a roll. This establishes a relationship, never automatic faction obedience.

Pantheon bonds and requests

Write one patron relationship (a living community, institution, spirit or unanswered presence) and one disputed teaching. When the crew seeks special religious aid, a patron may offer a **Request**: a concrete benefit in exchange for an obligation you can refuse. Example: archive access for recovering a lost survey; a shrine's ship berth for transporting pilgrims; ritual aid for returning an artifact. Requests are negotiated adventures, never a mandatory per-session demand. Accepting records a debt; breaking it changes that relationship but does not remove starting powers. Every Pantheon has dissenting schools and noncombatants. Religious activity can also be joyful, ordinary and freely offered.

At rank 3 choose a **Mantle**: **Steward** (once per session, completing a rescue or restoring a safe refuge restores 1 Supply), **Herald** (once per session, spend ten peaceful minutes leading a willing group in a shared observance; each participant clears 1 Strain), or **Seeker** (once per scene gain an edge investigating a relic, lost civilization or active rite). At rank 5 deepen your Mantle: Steward restores 2 Supply instead; Herald also restores one participant's Conviction to at least 2; Seeker may extend that edge to an ally instead. All three work in every Pantheon. New role-specific choices arrive at ranks 6-10 in Vocation paths.

Alternatively choose one of your Pantheon's three specific Mantle paths: Order's Patternwright, Network Steward or Severant; Ancients' Trailweaver, Memorybearer or Lifetender; Divinity's Lamplighter, Veilward or Thresholdkeeper. Choose **one common or Pantheon-specific Mantle**, not both. These paths also deepen at rank 5 and add distinct ways to use familiar powers without another separate currency.

Rites

Every rite costs one action and 1 Conviction unless stated otherwise. A rite targeting an unwilling enemy rolls Presence; Insight may replace it only where specified. Use the core outcome bands. For a hostile rite on 7-9, its effect happens and the caster takes 1 Strain; on failure no effect and 1 Strain; on 10+ full effect. For friendly/utility rites do not roll unless a stated external danger creates uncertainty; if a roll is needed use Presence and the same cost. Exceptional outcomes use the normal benefits. Rite durations never stack with themselves; recasting refreshes duration. An interrupted channel loses its cost.

Order

Starting - Bastion: one willing target in your zone reduces its next incoming damage by 2, minimum 0, before your next turn. **Starting - Measure the Fault:** roll Insight to analyze an enemy or device in sight. A success reveals one weakness and gives the next ally acting on it an edge this scene. Hostile rite outcomes apply if under opposition; out of danger it is automatic.

Unlock - Binding Line: one enemy in your or an adjacent visible zone cannot leave its zone until your next turn unless it spends its action breaking the line. It can still attack and use abilities. **Unlock - Relay:** move a willing ally in an adjacent visible zone into yours without using their move; if the path is blocked the rite cannot be used. Neither provokes an attack.

Ancients

Starting - Living Path: make one connection between your zone and an adjacent zone traversable for allies until your next turn, bypassing rough ground or one human-scale obstacle. It cannot cross an abyss, solid wall, or locked story barrier. **Starting - Star Witness:** reveal hidden creatures or active rites in your zone and adjacent visible zones until your next turn. It reveals positions, not private thoughts or every secret.

Unlock - Thornwake: one enemy in your or an adjacent visible zone takes 2 damage and must spend its move to leave that zone next turn (it may still spend its action to sprint). **Unlock - Renewal:** heal 2 Guard on one conscious willing target in your zone, up to wounded maximum. A given target can benefit from Renewal only once per scene, regardless of caster.

Divinity

Starting - Sanctuary: until your next turn, one willing ally in your zone gains an edge to defense; the rite ends early if that ally attacks. **Starting - Unmask:** suppress one visible rite affecting your or an adjacent zone until your next turn. It cannot suppress a Pantheon, intrinsic talent, relic's permanent nature, or another character's beliefs.

Unlock - Quiet Passage: you and one willing ally in your zone cannot be targeted by ranged attacks from other zones until your next turn. Moving or making an attack ends the effect for that character. **Unlock - Radiant Debt:** deal 3 damage to one enemy in your or an adjacent visible zone. Include 1 additional Strain in its activation cost regardless of the

eventual result. Combine it with any overreach Strain as one activation packet and resolve Fracture before rolling; its ordinary hostile partial/miss Strain still applies afterward.

Overreach

After paying the rite's action and Conviction but before rolling, take 2 Strain to extend its range by one adjacent visible zone or affect a second legal target. One overreach per rite; one roll applies to both targets. Only rites with explicit targets can add a target. Affinities cannot be overreached. Resolve Fracture immediately before the rite; if you become Downed or withdraw, the action ends, its costs remain spent and no rite occurs. Overreach never creates new theological facts or lets a combat rite control a community's belief.

Vocations

Vocation answers “what do you do?” Pantheon answers “what powers and obligations are you entangled with?” Any combination is legal. Start with the first talent. At rank 3 gain the second talent. At rank 5 gain the third. No Vocation changes your attributes or rite list.

Vocation	Starting talent	Rank 3	Rank 5	Kit
Bulwark	Once per round react to take an attack aimed at a willing ally in your zone; you roll defense	Once per scene reduce a hit you take by 2	Once per scene your interception also restores 1 Guard to the protected ally	Shield, close weapon, light armor
Wayrunner	Once per scene move one extra zone for free on your turn	Once per scene carry a willing or Downed ally during that extra move	Once per scene ignore an announced movement hazard during your extra move	Rope, ranged weapon, light armor
Envoy	Once per scene ask a speaking NPC what concrete concession would earn a ceasefire; receive an honest answer about their current intent, possibly “none”	Once per scene a willing ally hearing you clears 1 Strain as your action	Once per scene that action affects two allies	Credentials, close weapon, light armor
Artificer	Once per scene use an action to restore 2 Guard to a conscious ally in your zone with your kit	Once per scene use an action to disable a mundane device in your zone without a roll unless guarded	Once per scene your repair restores 3 instead of 2 Guard	Tools, close weapon, light armor
Witness	Once per scene ask which visible claim contradicts available physical evidence; Guide identifies one or says none	Once per scene give an ally an edge after seeing their roll, before outcome is resolved; still obey modifier cap	Once per scene reveal the announced next action of one visible enemy as a free observation	Recording kit, ranged weapon, light armor
Votary	Once per scene after paying for a rite regain 1 Conviction after resolution	Once per scene a successful rite clears 1 Strain from a willing ally in your zone	Once per scene that ally may also regain 1 Guard	Focus, close weapon, light armor

No talent grants extra enemy attacks, duplicate turns, or free automatic conversion. Regained Conviction cannot exceed 3. A Votary must have the cost available before receiving the refund.

Changing belief

A character can reject a teaching without losing their sheet. Changing Pantheon is a story arc: establish a new relationship through one session's meaningful actions, then exchange affinity and all known rites for the same number from the new Pantheon at the next safe recovery. No character may retain multiple Pantheon packages. Keep rank, Vocation, Provenance and wounds. Rewrite a Creed between sessions when events change the character; tell the group what changed and why.

03 / Campaign and advancement

Default campaign: a crew and its next adventure

The default campaign follows a crew through missions, discoveries and personal quests. After an expedition, give each PC one **downtime interval** of roughly a day or several safe watches. Choose one project: research a lead, earn 2 Supply through useful work, train (spend earned milestones), pursue a contact, treat a wound (one day +1 Supply), install a ship module (pay its cost), or participate in religious activity from chapter 7. Ordinary safe sleep and routine shopping do not consume this project. Ship repair uses its own stated watches and costs; it can happen alongside other PCs' projects, but the same PC cannot do two time-consuming projects at once.

Keep a mission log with objective, reward, unresolved consequence and new lead. End each adventure with two reachable options plus space for player proposals. Advance one relevant unresolved threat only when fiction supports it: a rival expedition departs, a missing ship's trail grows cold, a port announces an inspection. No need to run a political simulation between every session.

Trust and belonging

Track **Trust -2 to +2** with named communities/factions only when a relationship matters: -2 hostile, -1 wary, 0 unfamiliar, +1 welcoming, +2 trusted. Completing a meaningful commitment raises Trust by 1, at most once per adventure per community. Breaking one or harming people lowers it by 1. Religious service uses this same limit. Trust grants plausible introductions, access or hospitality; no flat roll bonus and no automatic control. Even a hostile faction contains individuals with reasons to talk. Relationship recovery needs meaningful reparations, not repeatable flattery rolls.

Choose a personal thread at creation: a missing person, bodily transformation, lost origin, sacred question, ambition, debt or homeworld obligation. The Guide offers at least one usable lead for one PC's thread each adventure, rotating spotlight. A thread can change, resolve or be abandoned by its player. It is not a compulsory secret plot twist.

Mission rewards

Prepare **payment, a wonder and a changed relationship** for each expedition: keep the ship running, open a strange new approach and create a future choice. Make the wonder discoverable through visible evidence. Players may refuse, miss or trade it. See Wonders and discoveries for six examples and placements.

Before accepting a paid mission, state the reward: ordinarily 3-4 Supply, a specific module, passage, restricted access or a relic. A modest cache is 2 Supply. Selling useful salvage requires a buyer; don't demand a full encounter for routine commerce. Supply cap is 8; surplus payment can directly fund repairs, Stores or purchases before capping. Ship Stores cap remains 6. Conversion between the two is one-way: 1 Supply buys 1 Stores at a supplier, not the reverse automatically.

Optional module: a living territorial map

Use this only if the group chooses to become a local political/religious power. It is not required by Pantheon membership, religious activity, character advancement or ship ownership. Keep Influence distinct from ordinary Trust; neither automatically converts into the other. Omit it entirely for a roaming adventure campaign.

Draw 3-7 sites connected by routes. Sites may be settlements, temples, stretches of water, farmland or industrial infrastructure. This graph abstracts the RTS's continuous Zeal field; it does not establish permanent political borders. For each site record a need, **Grievance 0-3**, and separate **Influence 0-3** for every active faction, including the party's coalition.

At the end of a campaign turn a faction supports a site if its Influence is at least 2 and strictly greater than every rival. Otherwise the site is contested or independent. Support gives access to ordinary local shelter and information; it never

transfers ownership of people, guarantees obedience, or produces passive expansion. A supported site also grants one logistical benefit per turn: recover 1 Supply **or** reveal one rival's next declared project. Benefits resolve after upkeep and cannot finance that same turn's upkeep.

After each adventure, or one week of downtime, take one campaign turn:

1. **Declare:** Guide reveals one specific intended project per rival faction, its target and what players can do to contest it. Hidden methods may remain unknown; stakes must be legible.
2. **Act:** the group chooses two projects total: serve a need, contest a rival, investigate, resupply, repair a route or pursue an adventure. Each project requires a scene or established sufficient resources, not a free roll. A successfully addressed local need raises your Influence there by 1 and lowers Grievance by 1. A successful contest lowers one rival's Influence there by 1. Resupply trades a real cache/favor for 2 Supply. Values clamp to their ranges.
3. **Rivals:** resolve one declared project for each rival not prevented by the party's actions. Each successful project changes at most 1 Influence at its named site; no automatic growth elsewhere. Describe the action: food delivery, organizing, intimidation or a rite. If contested without a scene, one representative PC rolls a relevant attribute using the announced stakes; 7-9 stop the project at a stated cost, 10+ stop it, 6- it proceeds. Never roll again for a project already decided during the adventure.
4. **Upkeep:** each faction chooses sites it actively sustains. Your coalition pays 1 Supply per site selected. Rivals each have 2 upkeep tokens per turn and may sustain at most two sites; spent tokens do not carry over. Every site where a faction has Influence but was not sustained loses 1 of that faction's Influence. Even a site gained this turn requires upkeep.
5. **Consequences:** at Grievance 3, lower every faction's Influence at that site by 1 and reset Grievance to 2. Reassess support. Resolve logistical benefits, then describe a changed border or allegiance. Coercion, broken public promises and avoidable civilian harm each add 1 Grievance when they occur, at most once per event.

No single action increases Influence by more than 1. Communities can refuse proposed bargains, flee or organize their own faction. A miracle without service does not automatically increase Influence. A leading faction must make commitments to hold its position. Losing a site creates new adventures instead of ending the campaign.

Advancement, ranks 1-10

At session end mark one milestone for resolving a significant objective, one for a costly Creed choice **or** helping another PC's personal quest at a real cost, and one for learning something that changed the group's plan (maximum three/session). Each character tracks individually; the group agrees what happened. Spend 4 milestones to gain one rank through a safe training downtime project; carry excess. Rank cannot exceed 10 in this alpha. A secular personal Creed is equally eligible.

New rank	Gain
2	+1 maximum Guard; learn a third rite from your Pantheon; choose a Discipline foundation and novice elective in chapters 8/12
3	+1 to an attribute, maximum +3; Vocation rank 3 talent; choose a Pantheon Mantle
4	+1 maximum Guard; learn your fourth Pantheon rite; gain second starting Vocation technique
5	Vocation rank 5 talent; deepen Mantle; choose a second Provenance expertise, justified by campaign experience

Ranks 6-10 are specified in Vocation paths, including adept/master Discipline features and advanced Pantheon rites. Guard additions apply before wounds. Maximum Conviction remains 3. No escalating attack bonuses or automatic extra

attacks. Advancement broadens capabilities. A new character joining a higher-rank group starts at group rank so players stay effective.

Duet: one player and one Guide

Use one PC plus a companion: Guard 4, no Conviction, no rites, all attributes +1, damage 1. The companion gets one move and action each round controlled by the player; help, stabilize and objective work are legal. It cannot grant Creed resources or use contacts. In ship scenes it may take one station action; its Spacecraft expertise is +0. Start Accord 2 and Supply 4 as normal. Use **one regular enemy at a time**, bringing a second only after a clear warning. Reduce starter clocks by 2, minimum 2, except clocks explicitly labeled countdown or emergency. The PC has normal abilities; avoid doubling statistics. Put capture, retreat and negotiation on the table before defeat. The companion can be an established contact or a new character, never an imposed canonical protagonist.

Experimental skirmish: two players, no Guide

This mode tests tactical rules; it does not replace the RPG. Each player fields one rank 1 protagonist and two **retinue** units. Retinue: Guard 4, all attributes +1, damage 1, no rites, no armor, no personal Conviction. To avoid resolving every strike twice, **only the attacker rolls** in this mode: use PC strike/rite outcomes against all targets; do not also make a defense roll. Cover or an effect granting a defense edge instead gives the attacker one situational hindrance (normal cap/netting applies). Other protective effects reduce damage normally. Retinue cannot spend a hero's Conviction. Each side has its own Accord 1 with no replenishment in this format. NPC enemy-turn/defense rules do not apply here. Do not generalize this experimental exception into Guide-run RPG encounters.

Build five zones: center linked to each of two home zones and two flank zones; each flank links to both homes. Put an objective at center and each flank. Each home has one cover position. All units deploy at their own home. Flip a coin for first activation in round 1; alternate first player each later round. Players alternate activating one unactivated unit (move + action) until all have activated. Downed units cannot activate. Once all finish, score and begin the next round. One reaction/unit/round as usual.

An uncontested unit at an objective spends an action to claim it; place your marker. An enemy present prevents claiming. At round end score 1 point for each objective you have claimed **and currently occupy uncontested**. A marker alone produces nothing. A unit may contest an objective while Downed only if both players agree before play; default is no. First to 7 points at round end wins; if both reach 7 compare points. Stop after six rounds, higher points wins. Ties are draws. You can also win if no opposing unit can act and none can be stabilized by an active ally.

No reinforcements, healing recovery between rounds, campaign influence or hidden objectives. Stabilize as normal but stabilized units remain inactive for the match. Scenario names, Pantheon identities and point balance are prototypes. Record first-player and Pantheon win rates before treating this as competitive play.

Warband escalation in RPG campaigns

At rank 3 a group can spend 2 Supply to recruit one retinue for the next adventure, maximum two for the whole group. Use the retinue profile above but enemies target them through PC defense rolls. Assign each to a player. A unit acts immediately after that player's PC, using its own move/action. It can help, attack and stabilize; it has no expertise or talents. Pay 1 Supply per retinue after each adventure to keep it, or let it return home safely. Retinue don't generate Conviction, milestones or free Influence. Recruitment requires willing people, not ownership tokens.

Add one regular opponent per retinue. Each retinue acts immediately after its assigned PC within that crew activation, then the enemy responds. This is a personal-scale retinue experiment; it does not provide costed army formations or artillery rules.

05 / Lineages, bodies and equipment

Lineage describes inherited nature; Embodiment describes how you exist now. People of every Lineage follow different religions, join competing factions and practice different professions. Humanity includes biological, engineered, augmented, mechanical and psionic ways of living, often within the same community.

Lineage: inherited nature

Choose one. All use the same attributes, Guard, equipment access and advancement. Adaptations grant specific permissions or limited abilities, never universal superiority. Bodies vary within each Lineage; describe access needs and equipment together. No Lineage is assigned one culture or Pantheon.

Lineage	Adaptation	Limit / useful distinction
Human	**Versatility:** choose a second starting expertise: Machinery, Routes, Care, Watchfulness, Records, Improvisation or Spacecraft	Still only one expertise per roll. Baseline humans need sealed suits in vacuum; humans can choose every Embodiment below
Veyran	**Echo Sense:** while touching a solid surface, detect movement in your own zone through darkness, smoke or a thin partition; no roll to detect presence	Does not identify individuals, read records or extend weapon range. Thick isolation or no shared solid surface blocks it
Oruun	**Anchor Frame:** once per scene as a reaction ignore forced movement from a hit or hazard; take the damage normally	Larger frame needs adapted seats and suits, included in starting kit. Cannot ignore ship-scale forces or gravity
Nacrean	**Amphibious:** breathe ordinary air and fresh/salt water; move through water without a swimming check unless facing a separate hazard	Toxic liquids, pressure extremes and vacuum still need equipment. Water does not bypass fatigue or a blocked passage

The peoples and civilizations dossier describes several societies without making one culture compulsory for every member of a species. Human is a species; an artificial human body can remain a human identity. Embodiment and citizenship are separate questions.

Embodiment: how you exist now

Choose one at creation, independently of Lineage. This is a second modest package, not a full Vocation. All starting equipment accommodates your body, and ordinary food/maintenance is covered by Supply. No human form is the “real” or morally superior human. Other Lineages may use compatible versions; describe the translation without stacking multiple packages.

Embodiment	Starting feature	Tradeoff
Unmodified	Once per session after inspecting a failed practical attempt, identify one ordinary tool or approach that would make a retry possible; Guide names a reachable option	No automatic success or new resource; still need the option

Embodiment	Starting feature	Tradeoff
Gene-Crafted	Choose amphibious breathing **or** once/scene ignore 1 damage from poison, radiation or biological contamination	Specialized physiology is not immunity; environmental protection still matters. Amphibious choice gives no second benefit to a Nacrean
Augmented	Choose a concealed manipulator, low-light optical implant, or integrated communicator; using it needs no hand	Implant allows the normal task, no bonus. The communicator can be detected/jammed; low light does not see through walls or total darkness
Mechanical Continuant	You can survive one exploration watch in vacuum without a suit and ordinary recovery can use repair tools instead of medical tools	After that watch you need shelter/power. Hazardous radiation, decompression impact and weapons still harm you. Personal Guard/wounds remain unchanged; this grants no ship-level durability
Psionically Attuned	Once per scene send a brief thought to a willing person in your or an adjacent visible zone, and receive a brief willing reply	Cannot read minds, locate strangers, force a reply or replace a communicator across space

Mechanical Continuants may be born synthetic, transferred persons, or heavily reconstructed humans; these are proposed explanations, not settled cosmology. Religious traditions may disagree about continuity of identity; the Guide never overrides a player's ownership of their character's personhood.

Embodiment changes require a safe downtime project and consent: a reputable clinic/workshop, one adventure-scale favor or 3 Supply, and a week's recovery. Exchange packages; do not stack old and new benefits. Cosmetic aids, ordinary prosthetics and accessibility equipment need no mechanical penalty or paid package.

Gear and loadouts

All new characters receive communicator, sealed excursion suit, Vocation tools, ordinary weapon and light armor. Tools permit tasks; they don't add bonuses. Choose looks and technology freely within the region: a close weapon may be a powered blade or staff; a ranged weapon a slugthrower, arc projector or compact energy weapon. Identical profiles have identical effects.

Gear	Cost in Supply	Rule
Ordinary close/ranged weapon	1	Damage 2; close own zone, ranged own/adjacent visible zone
Bulky projector	2	Damage 3, ranged; cannot move and fire on the same turn
Stun setting / nonlethal tool	1, or choose at creation	Damage 1; NPC at Guard 0 is safely incapacitated unless an independent hazard intervenes
Light armor	1	Once per scene reduce one hit by 1, minimum 0
Heavy shell	3	Once per scene reduce one hit by 2 instead; cannot use free extra movement from a Vocation technique while worn
Field med/repair kit	1	Permits treatment of wounds and basic repairs; wound healing still costs time and 1 Supply
Climbing/boarding rig	1	Permits anchored EVA and difficult climbing; does not make hazardous movement automatic

Gear	Cost in Supply	Rule
Survey scanner	1	Identifies atmospheric safety, obvious power sources and life-sign presence in own/adjacent visible zone after an action
Breaching charge	1/use	One action to plant, one to detonate remotely; destroys an ordinary door/obstruction, not a boss, sealed vault or ship hull by fiat
Smoke canister	1/use	Obscures one zone until your next turn; ranged attacks crossing it impossible without another precise sense; close attacks unaffected
Suit patch	1/use	One action seals one damaged personal suit for the remainder of the expedition

Cannot combine light and heavy armor uses. Heavy shell leaves ordinary moves intact. Scarce equipment requires a reachable supplier or salvage, not an invisible shop everywhere. At a functioning port, modest paid work or salvage earns 2 Supply; a dangerous mission normally pays 3-4. Do not convert supplies into both ship Stores and personal goods without paying each cost.

Vacuum and alien environments

A sealed functioning suit supports one **watch** (four hours) of activity, then needs a ship/refuge recharge. Recharging at safe infrastructure is free; emergency field renewal costs 1 Supply for all crew suits. Every character can use a suit adapted to their body. If a suit is breached, announce the breach and give one full turn to reach shelter, use a patch or receive help; after that take 2 Guard damage at each round end until protected. No extra suffocation damage on the initial breach turn. Without a suit in vacuum, use the same one-turn grace and damage unless an Embodiment says otherwise. Stowed survival gear is not destroyed without a declared hazard and a chance to respond.

Extreme heat, cold, toxins and radiation are obstacles, not blanket penalties. State a concrete exposure consequence before the crew commits: usually 1 Strain per dangerous watch or a task to establish protection. Good preparation can remove the roll. No “alien air is safe” assumption without scanning, local knowledge or a sealed suit.

Zero gravity and vehicles

In zero gravity, anchored boots, handholds, tethers or a suit's maneuvering pack permit normal zone movement. Without them you can push toward a visible adjacent surface as your move, but cannot change direction until you reach it; announced intervening hazards may require Finesse. Never impose a die roll simply for every step in a prepared EVA. A burst of recoil may reveal an unanchored shooter's position, but does not secretly take their next turn. Forced movement still follows ordinary effects; an Oruun anchor reaction needs a surface, tether or pack to act against in open space.

Small rovers and shuttles use **Structure 6**, one pilot, ordinary cargo and personal-scale occupants. Routine travel is automatic. A hazard uses the pilot's relevant roll: partial 1 Structure damage or a watch delay, failure stranded in a reachable place with a repair task. At 0 Structure the vehicle stops; crew remain able to act. Personal weapons can disable exposed wheels/components through a 4-clock task when appropriate, rather than treating every ordinary bullet as anti-ship fire. Vehicles do not grant free extra attacks. Full vehicle combat and mass battles remain future work.

06 / Exploration and ships

Your ship carries the crew between working ports, strange worlds, drifting habitats and places absent from current charts. Choosing a destination, route and purpose begins an expedition. Travel creates opportunities for preparation, discovery, conflict and companionship; routine flight can pass in a few sentences.

An expedition loop

1. **Choose a lead:** job, distress call, personal mystery, pilgrimage, survey, salvage or faction mission. State the objective, known risks and reward. The crew may refuse or negotiate.
2. **Prepare:** select route, buy supplies, inspect a map and arrange contacts. Known hazards permit useful planning. A port isn't a mandatory religious checkpoint.
3. **Travel:** mark Stores, resolve a meaningful route obstacle only if present, arrive somewhere changed by elapsed time.
4. **Explore:** investigate places, make discoveries, meet people, overcome hazards and fight when needed. Treasure, knowledge and relationships all count as useful results.
5. **Return or press on:** secure a reward, repair, train and choose a new lead. The Guide advances one relevant unresolved threat, with an observable sign; no automatic territory phase.

Avoid requiring rolls for routine flight, normal shopping or every room. Resolve one roll per meaningful obstacle. A failed navigation roll changes route, time or resources; it does not erase the adventure.

Time, routes and Stores

A **watch** is four hours of significant activity. A **leg** is one plotted journey between nearby destinations, usually several watches or days; the Guide declares duration before departure. Interstellar **passages** follow surveyed transit corridors and count as two legs, normally several days. No precise light-year engine model is asserted. Unmapped passages require an expedition, not a blind roll to any world desired.

Ships have **Stores 0-6**: fuel, drive consumables, air reserves and ship spares. Pay 1 Stores per leg on departure. At a functioning port, 1 personal Supply buys 1 Stores; a mission may pay Stores directly instead. The crew may negotiate a loan or transport favor if stranded. At Stores 0 you cannot start a leg; local distress communication, bargaining and short emergency rescue remain possible. Do not trap the campaign behind an invisible fuel wall.

The Guide describes two viable routes when there is a meaningful choice: safe/long (two legs) or risky/short (one leg plus announced hazard). A successful risky-route navigation roll uses Insight/Spacecraft; 7-9 arrive with either +1 Stores spent or one watch delay and a new encounter, player chooses; 6- arrive at a reachable refuge with that encounter and a needed repair task; 10+ arrive as planned. If no threatened destination or resource matters, travel is narration.

Shared ship

Choose one at creation; all start Hull full, Stores 4/6 and one installed module. Hull and personal Guard are different scales: infantry guns don't chip down starship Hull. Boarding, sabotage or heavy emplacements can threaten systems through scenes.

Hull frame	Hull	Cargo slots	Identity / limitation
Courier	8	2	Once per ship scene a successful Maneuver changes Engagement by 2 instead of 1; carrying a bulky cargo uses both slots
Surveyor	8	3	Its sensors reveal one additional physical feature on a successful scan; limited to one weapon station even with modules
Hauler	10	5	Carries vehicles/prefab shelters as one bulky two-slot cargo; cannot change Engagement by more than 1 per action

All have crew bunks, a modest medical/workbench area, airlock, communications, navigation station, propulsion and one ordinary weapon station. Choose exterior, origin and ship name. Extra modules add capabilities, not whole private armies. A module costs 3 Supply at a suitable port and one downtime interval to install; maximum three modules per ship.

Module	Capability
Sanctuary berth	One safe onboard Recovery each expedition costs no Supply; conditions must actually be safe
Deep survey array	Scans can penetrate ordinary dust/interference; not shielding, unknown encryption or a relic's secrets
Fabrication bay	Once/expedition convert recovered salvage into 1 Supply after a watch; cannot create salvage or Stores from nothing
Concealed hold	Conceals one cargo slot from a routine glance; deliberate inspection remains an obstacle
Boarding collar	Permits safe docked crossing to a compatible cooperating ship, or a successful forced docking task
Second weapon station	A second PC may fire in a round; no third station, and each fires at most once/round

Ship encounters

Use rounds only during pursuit, battle or an urgent maneuver. A ship encounter uses **Engagement 0-3** against one main opponent or coordinated group: 0 separated, 1 sensor/long range, 2 weapon range, 3 docking distance. Start at the declared situation, usually 1. The crew may move between stations freely between its turns; no station grants a free extra action. Each PC chooses one station action per round, then the enemy ship takes **one** action. PCs may help rather than operate a station. One action cannot both contribute to a task and perform its listed full effect.

Station action	Resolution
Maneuver - Finesse or Insight	Once per crew round. On 7+ increase/decrease Engagement by 1; 7-9 also take 1 Hull damage or spend 1 Stores; failure no change and 1 Hull damage; 12+ also avoid the next environmental hazard this round
Fire - Finesse	Engagement 2-3, one PC per weapon station. Success deals 2 Hull damage, 7-9 gunner takes 1 Strain; miss takes 1 Strain. 12+ may add 1 damage or a normal exceptional benefit
Scan - Insight	7+ reveal Hull, obvious weapon and one vulnerability or cargo clue; 7-9 transmit your own signature to witnesses; failure the next enemy shot ignores a Brace. No secret metaphysics from one scan

Station action	Resolution
Brace / Repair - Insight	Once per crew round choose reduce next enemy hit by 2 (automatic) or repair 2 Hull by spending 1 Stores (automatic). Cannot repair Hull 0 during combat
Hail - Presence	Use ordinary social rules; concrete terms may work without a roll. A success can secure a ceasefire with a willing negotiator, not override an enemy's nonnegotiable objective
Board / Sabotage	At Engagement 3, a collar plus successful 4-clock docking task establishes a route; resolve personal-scale scenes on both ships. Ships must remain near one another during boarding

Enemy ships do not roll. Their action is either attempt to shift Engagement by 1, fire if at 2-3, begin boarding at 3, or work an announced objective. **Enemy Maneuver:** the crew may allow the stated shift automatically. To resist it, one pilot rolls Finesse or Insight with relevant Spacecraft expertise: 6- the shift happens; 7-9 choose to allow it or prevent it by spending 1 Stores or taking 1 Hull damage; 10+ prevent it; 12+ may also change Engagement by 1 in your chosen direction. This defense does not spend the pilot's next station action or use the crew's once/round Maneuver. Brace doesn't reduce this voluntary maneuver cost. No enemy move and fire in the same action.

Enemy Fire: one chosen pilot PC rolls Finesse/Spacecraft defense: 6- take listed Hull damage; 7-9 choose full damage or half rounded up plus 1 Hull damage to an installed module (System Damage); 10+ avoid; 12+ also change Engagement by 1. System Damage is a marker disabling one chosen module until repaired; it is **not** a second reduction to Hull. A disabled module cannot be chosen for another System Damage until repaired. If no operational module exists, choose full damage. Brace reduces the main hit, minimum 0; it never cancels System Damage.

Escape: reach Engagement 0, then use a successful Maneuver on a later crew round to align departure instead of changing range. On a partial pay its normal cost; on failure remain at 0 and take its ordinary 1 Hull damage. A pursuer may try to close on its own action, but the pilot can resist using Enemy Maneuver above. It cannot automatically cancel every successful range change. Hull 0 interrupts departure. This uses that round's one Maneuver; there is no reduction below 0 and no separate escape resource.

A known safe port reached ends pursuit if the pursuer cannot legally follow; hostile ships are not automatically suicidal. Three enemy ships can be represented as one coordinated group with a single turn, not three full-damage attacks against a starter crew. The Guide announces that abstraction.

Ship opponent	Hull	Damage	Behavior
Salvage skiff	4	2	Wants unattended cargo; retreats below Hull 2
Patrol cutter	8	3	Warns, inspects, then disables; accepts legal evidence or negotiated bond
Raider pair (group)	10	3	Seeks surrender and cargo; uses one turn total; splits/flees below Hull 4

Hull zero and recovery

At Hull 0 the ship is disabled, cannot maneuver/fire, and drifts at current Engagement. State a **4-round emergency clock**. Each round characters can use their actions to fill a shared 4-clock Stabilization task (Insight for repairs, Force for closing bulkheads, Presence for coordinating evacuees). Completing it stabilizes life support and cancels the emergency; the ship still needs a tow or dockyard. If the emergency expires, launch escape pods or accept rescue/capture; don't announce unavoidable crew death. Boarding remains possible if the enemy secures a route. A disabled enemy normally surrenders, evacuates or is boarded; no need to destroy everyone.

At a safe port, spend one watch and 1 Supply to restore 3 Hull **or** repair one System Damage; repeat with real time/cost. A ship at 0 Hull needs a dockyard, one day and 2 Supply to restore it to Hull 3 before ordinary repairs. A crew with no funds can take a repair-debt job with stated terms.

Exploration procedures

For a new location write **three discoveries, two hazards and one person who wants something**. Include a physical discovery, cultural discovery and unanswered mystery. Distinguish what scanners reveal from what people interpret. Never require the Votary for every door or the Artificer for every clue.

On a dangerous world use watches. Each watch the crew chooses explore, travel, research, shelter or treat someone. Announce a known exposure or approaching threat before they commit. Routine movement needs no roll; a climbing chasm, hostile patrol or failing pressure dome is a scene. At the end of a watch advance one established environmental threat if it actually applies, not an automatic random attack.

Research: establish a question, evidence source and 4/6-clock task. Access is an adventure if contested. Partial results give usable information; failure introduces a rival researcher, missing sample or spent watch rather than a fabricated “fact.”
First contact: establish a shared sign or translator, learn a concrete need, offer an exchange and respect refusal. A Presence roll handles reception under uncertainty; it does not reveal a culture's complete language or convert its people.

Relics: inspect before activation. The Guide states a known use, cost and visible warning. Unknown functions need evidence, not random irreversible punishment. Three ready relics:

Relic	Use	Cost / restriction
Pilgrim Lens	Once/scene reveal the safest traversable connection out of your zone, including one concealed mundane route	Action +1 Conviction; cannot create a route or see through a shielded vault
Memory Seed	Once/session replay a minute of recorded sensory history from a compatible archive	Ten minutes and a supplied archive fragment; a record is a perspective, not objective truth
Anchor Bell	Once/scene secure your zone against human-scale forced movement until your next turn	Action +1 Conviction; allies and enemies benefit; does not stop vacuum damage or a collapsing ship

An artifact's origin, owner and disputed meaning are story rewards. Activated field relics use the two-readied-relic limit in the armory. A copied route chart or ordinary research archive doesn't use a slot. Relics enable actions and discoveries; their use doesn't automatically convert a community or create territorial control.

07 / Religious life

Order, Ancients and Divinity are broad traditions shared across worlds and species. The regional mythology introduces nine commonly honored figures. Their temples, schools and observances connect people who may agree about a sacred story and disagree about nearly everything else. The world contains genuine wonders, ordinary kindness and sincere disagreement.

Religion belongs in daily life

A character's relationship can be **observant**, **culturally affiliated**, **seeking**, or **dissenting**. These are descriptions, not bonus packages. Choose a symbol or practice, a place of belonging and something you question. A starship may contain a shrine, a quiet chamber, an ancestor archive, or none of these. Religious life includes weddings, naming, mourning, music, food, festivals, hospitality, study and service. It need not always be coercion or war.

One Pantheon can contain several religions, schools and political factions. A faction can include multiple Pantheons. Humans and nonhumans can share traditions while disagreeing within them. A mechanical person is not automatically Order; a gene-crafted person is not automatically Ancients; a psion is not automatically Divinity. Hierophant is a Discipline, not a requirement to be devout.

Order

Adventure identity: preserve something valuable through knowledge, coordination and deliberate work. Temples may be public workshops, teaching hospitals, oath halls or precisely maintained observatories. Religious authority may rest with builders, witnesses or councils rather than a single priesthood.

Proposed tradition: “A promise becomes real in the work that survives it.” Before a voyage, a crew may name one system it will maintain for strangers as well as itself. Funerary observance records the unfinished work of the deceased; accepting it is voluntary.

Internal schools: Architects trust durable institutions and shared standards; Dissenters insist that a system must remain repairable by those living within it. Neither school monopolizes compassion or intelligence. A reliable hospital can be sacred without controlling its patients. A workshop can become unjust if its experts refuse outside scrutiny.

Questions for a character: What have you built? Whose authority do you trust? Which system should be rebuilt rather than preserved? **Invitations to adventure:** recover a lost construction archive; mediate ownership of a shipyard sanctuary; rescue an engineer whose correct warning threatens a patron's reputation.

Advanced rites (choose at ranks 7/8 under chapter 8; normal action, cost and outcome rules):

- **Pattern Lock:** target one visible enemy device or mechanical foe in your/adjacent zone. It cannot use one declared special action until your next turn. Ordinary attacks and moves remain; a sentient machine's beliefs/personhood are unaffected.
- **Shelter Grid:** choose up to three willing creatures in your zone; each reduces their next incoming hit by 1 before your next turn. Cannot stack with Bastion: each target chooses one reduction, not both. This rite already has several targets and cannot add more through overreach.
- **Reconstruction:** restore 2 Guard to a conscious target or restore one destroyed mundane tool in your zone. Each recipient/tool benefits only once per scene. Does not remove wounds, recover ship Hull, fabricate missing exotic components or resurrect people.

Ancients

Adventure identity: explore old worlds, keep relationships alive and discover what inherited stories conceal. Sacred places can be living landscapes, star charts, nomadic fleets, ancestor libraries or carefully tended habitats. “Ancient” describes a relationship to memory, not a requirement to reject technology.

Proposed tradition: “Carry what can still grow; release what cannot.” On arriving somewhere new, travelers share a record of a place they left. Mourning may include planting a living memorial or restoring a damaged archive. There are secular members who honor cultural memory without claiming contact with spirits.

Internal schools: Keepers preserve places and obligations; Wanderers believe relationships survive by traveling and adapting. Some communities use gene-craft to repair devastated ecologies, while others distrust commercial ownership of living lineages. Neither view is universal.

Questions: What memory do you carry? What did your ancestors misunderstand? What deserves a future rather than a perfect reconstruction? **Adventures:** survey a planet with conflicting origin stories; escort a memory archive through hostile space; investigate an apparently sacred species without treating its people as specimens.

Advanced rites:

- **Rooted Haven:** until your next turn willing creatures in your zone ignore damage from one named ongoing terrain hazard, such as toxic spores or unstable footing. Does not block weapon hits, vacuum or ship destruction.
- **Astral Thread:** ask where a previously studied marked object went within the current location. A success reveals the next reachable direction or confirms it left the location; shielding may block a precise answer. No tracking across star systems from one roll.
- **Ancestral Echo:** inspect a site for ten minutes, spend 1 Conviction, and ask one question about an observable historical event. If a physical or supernatural trace remains, receive a sensory fragment plus its limitation; if none remains, learn that without paying Conviction. Cannot invent certainty, read private thoughts, or decide a murder mystery without interpretation.

Divinity

Adventure identity: protect people at the edge of ordinary knowledge and confront the possibilities of transformation. Temples can be hospices, radiant gathering places, secluded research sanctuaries or ships offering passage to pilgrims. Awe is not the same thing as obedience.

Proposed tradition: “A threshold matters because someone must cross it.” Communities mark beginnings and endings with light, silence or music. Their aid can be freely offered. Some regard unusual powers as gifts; others as responsibilities or unexplained phenomena.

Internal schools: Lanterns make sacred work publicly accountable; Threshold communities safeguard intimate rites and vulnerable participants. Both can become intolerant, generous, brave or mistaken. Psionic practice may be religious, clinical or independent; Divinity does not own it.

Questions: What transformation do you seek? What must remain yours? Who shares the cost of your power? **Adventures:** recover pilgrims from a silent station; investigate an artifact promising continuity after death; protect a rite's participants while exposing a fraudulent sponsor.

Advanced rites:

- **Luminous Intercession:** react when a willing ally in your zone would be Downed. Spend 1 Conviction and take 2 Strain to leave them at 1 Guard instead. Once/session; no roll, no overreach. Resolve your Fracture after saving the ally; you may be Downed yourself.

- **Veil of Quiet:** until your next turn, prevent outside creatures hearing speech or sensing active rites within your zone. Does not make people invisible, block cameras or stop an attack. Already affects a zone; no extra target through overreach.
- **Threshold Flame:** deal 2 damage to one visible enemy in your/adjacent zone and suppress one protective rite on it until your next turn. Does not suppress armor, inherent traits or technology. Use normal hostile rite roll/cost, including Strain on partial/failure.

Religious activity with practical value

Start with a small recurring practice: checking a rescue cable while naming its previous keeper, sharing a meal before departure, recording a place's changing name, or lighting a lamp for someone absent. It should be something the character does, not a test of the player's personal beliefs. A ship's quiet workbench can be as meaningful as a cathedral.

Brief observance: once/expedition, ten peaceful minutes in actual safety restore your Conviction to 3. It is not a downtime project. Describe the practice; another character may join willingly but is not required. A secular reflection, craft routine or shared remembrance rooted in a Creed can serve the same purpose. Ordinary prayer and everyday religious life remain available after the mechanical use is spent.

For the extended activities below, choose **one** in place of your ordinary downtime project. Each takes a watch unless noted. None replaces wound care or restores ship Stores. Fellow participants join willingly; other players may pursue unrelated projects.

Activity	Requirements	Benefit
Retreat / extended observance	A safe watch, a familiar practice and a question you want to explore	Gain one concrete lead about the named question from a reachable participant, archive or site; no automatic truth without evidence
Service	Fulfill a community's concrete need	Gain a named contact or +1 Trust with that community, once/adventure; no automatic cash
Pilgrimage	Complete a previously agreed destination/act over one or more adventures	Gain one factual lead from the site's keeper and a safe berth for this visit
Study / debate	Reachable archive or informed, willing counterpart	Learn a specific teaching, historical account or controversy; get one edge when that information matters this adventure
Memorial / celebration	Willing participants and meaningful occasion	Restore 1 shared Accord, once/session, maximum 3
Consecration	Negotiate access to a shrine and commit a specific act of care	A refuge admits willing travelers this expedition, subject to real capacity; no bonus damage or permanent control

Many temples offer ordinary hospitality without a quest. Special access, restricted archives and dangerous rites can require earned trust. Never charge every religious scene a resource fee. PCs may earn the same practical shelter and leads through secular communities.

Put convictions into the next scene

At the start of an adventure ask each player what their Creed might cost here. Offer a visible opportunity, not a surprise moral trap. The player decides whether to take it. One meaningful cost can restore 1 Conviction under the core rule, sharing its once/scene limit rather than adding another recharge.

Tradition	A playable opportunity	Real cost to choose
Order	Keep a promised evacuation berth for a stranger	Give up a profitable cargo place or accept a longer exposed route
Ancients	Carry a living sample or disputed record out of danger	Leave an optional valuable object behind or reveal your presence to its rightful custodian
Divinity	Share the way through a threshold	Take an ally's clearly stated danger or surrender exclusive access so others can pass

These opportunities do not compel a theology or action. A player may uphold a different interpretation, challenge an institution, or decline a cost. Failure to claim a recharge never makes the character less truly faithful. Ordinary Push Strain and casting payments alone do not qualify; an additional consequence or foregone opportunity must matter.

Human factions: examples, not species blocks

These small regional organizations are usable in the starter sector, not a canon declaration that humanity has five empires. Membership is optional, mixed-belief and internally disputed. Choose a faction tie only if desired; it grants a contact and an obligation, **no additional numerical bonus**.

Proposed faction	What it offers	Diversity / conflict	Adventure hook
Meridian Civic Compact	Courts, navigation charters, mutual rescue agreements	Human-majority member ports contain all three Pantheons, secular administrations and rival political parties	A lawful quarantine has outlived its evidence
Helix Cooperative	Gene-clinics, environmental adaptation, patient-owned research	Religious and secular biotic schools disagree about heritable changes and commercial patents	Recover a stolen treatment without handing patient records to a sponsor
Continuance Guild	Mechanical bodies, reconstruction, identity registries	Persons differ on transfer, memory editing and inheritance; many follow Ancients or Divinity as well as Order	Two legitimate continuants claim the same pledged ship
Quiet Reach Network	Psionic education, voluntary mental-health support, secure mediation	Some chapters are temples; others are research collectives. Consent is a policy that can be tested by bad actors	A distress thought reaches several unconnected students
Open Passage Fellowship	Pilgrim transport, interfaith refuge, rescue ships	Devout clergy, doubters and independent crews argue about scarce berths and dangerous destinations	Carry strangers who disagree about the relic traveling with them

Psions are not a state, a religion or a biologically uniform people. A faction's leader does not speak for all humanity. Show ordinary meals, work, entertainment, family and disagreement alongside doctrine.

Zeal: optional and local

Do not track a universal Zeal meter for every character or world. Standard campaigns use Conviction for personal powers and Trust for relationships. For an explicitly supernatural contested site, the Guide may define a **local Zeal phenomenon**: a beacon's resonance, a temple's protective field, or a visibly shifting sanctified boundary. State its reach, activation, upkeep, counterplay and end condition before using it. It never changes a player's beliefs or a community's consent automatically.

Example: a beacon grants safe passage through one radiation corridor while a character actively channels at its console. Channeling spends their action each round, costs 1 Conviction at activation, and ends if they leave or are Downed. Anyone can interrupt it by disabling power with a successful 4-clock task. This is a site-specific rule, not a mandatory battlefield aura. The optional influence module in chapter 3 is available only when the table wants a territorial campaign.

08 / Vocation paths and Disciplines

Vocation defines your practical role. **Discipline** is the specialization layer: biological engineering, machinery, psionics, sacred practice or independent fieldcraft. Humans participate in all of them across different factions and religions; no package defines humanity as a whole. Any Lineage/Pantheon/Vocation/Discipline combination is legal. An unmodified human can be a psionic trainee, a mechanical person can be a Votary, and an engineer can be deeply religious.

Vocation techniques

In addition to the starting Vocation talent in chapter 2, choose one starting technique below. At rank 4 learn the other. Techniques cost an action unless they explicitly say otherwise. Once/scene means once per individual technique, not once for the whole Vocation. These are deliberate choices for encounter, exploration and social play; they do not add flat attributes.

Vocation	Technique A	Technique B
Bulwark	**Clear the Way:** make a close strike; on a hit choose normal damage or no damage and move the target into one adjacent safe zone you can reach. Cannot move anchored/ship-scale targets	**Hold Fast:** once/scene act to protect a conscious willing ally in your zone; until your next turn they ignore forced movement and you may intercept for them normally
Wayrunner	**Flanking Route:** once/scene after moving into an enemy's zone, give the next ally attacking that enemy an edge this round, no action	**Pathfinder:** once/scene spend ten minutes surveying terrain; reveal one concealed traversable connection or confirm there is none. Hazards remain hazards
Envoy	**Read the Room:** once/scene ask who present has the authority to agree to your concrete request and what constrains them; get a truthful observable answer	**Rally:** once/scene a conscious willing ally in your zone may immediately move one zone or stand from a temporary pinned position; no attack or extra action
Artificer	**Field Hack:** roll Insight to operate a reachable ordinary terminal or drone; use a task clock for protected systems. Success changes one function, not every network	**Emergency Rig:** once/scene make a temporary tool from salvage; it works for one ordinary task then fails safely. Can't fabricate ammunition, Supply, relics or life support
Witness	**Combat Reading:** once/scene observe a visible foe; reveal its Guard, armor and one special action. No new attack bonus	**Trace:** once/scene inspect an object for ten minutes; learn where it was last used or handled if evidence exists, otherwise learn why the trail ends
Votary	**Consecrate:** once/scene spend ten peaceful minutes observing with willing companions; restore your Conviction to 3 instead of recovering other resources. It cannot be repeated by renaming the same scene	**Ritual Literacy:** identify the Pantheon and practical purpose of a visible ordinary rite or shrine without a roll. A damaged/unknown relic may require research rather than a false answer

Hacking does not read a living mind or seize a sentient character. Controlling unwilling intelligent beings is negotiated like other social conflict, never a terminal action. A Field Hack failure triggers a stated alarm, lockout or trace, not arbitrary destruction of a player's body.

Discipline: choose at rank 2

Take one novice feature at rank 2, its adept feature at rank 6 and master feature at rank 9. This is a full specialization progression, independent of your Pantheon and Embodiment. Each path offers technological, cultural and religious interpretations. Foundation features use their listed limits, materials or Strain; electives can explicitly modify a rite's Conviction cost. Bonuses still respect the normal edge cap. No compulsory faction membership.

These are the **foundation features**. At those same ranks also choose one novice, adept and master elective respectively. Read only the tier you have reached; the elective makes two characters of the same Discipline play differently without a new resource currency.

Discipline	Novice - rank 2	Adept - rank 6	Master - rank 9
Biotic	Once/scene use an action and medical tools to give a willing target in your zone an adaptation until scene end: tolerate ordinary water breathing, low atmospheric oxygen, or contaminated air. No vacuum/pressure immunity	Once/scene after you restore Guard by an ability, its target also clears 1 Strain	Once/session after a full recovery remove one wound from a willing target using medical tools; costs 1 Supply, no additional full day
Mechanist	Once/scene deploy a tool drone in your zone: for one action it gives a nearby ally an edge on repair, survey or hacking. It then returns; cannot attack, absorb damage or grant additional turns	Once/scene use an action to restore 2 Hull to a ship while at its engineering station and at Engagement 0; no recovery of a ship at Hull 0	Once/session before a ship or device hazard resolves, declare an installed fail-safe: negate one ship System Damage or one destroyed mundane tool. Costs 1 Stores for ships or 1 Supply for gear
Psion	Once/scene take 1 Strain and use an action to move a hand-sized unattended object in your or an adjacent visible zone. Cannot move living beings, trigger unknown controls, or attack	Once/scene react when a conscious willing ally in your zone takes Strain; take up to 2 of that Strain instead. Resolve your Fracture immediately	Once/session use an action, take 2 Strain, and lift or shift a human-sized unattended obstruction in your zone. No ship-scale effects, automatic enemy harm or movement through sealed barriers
Hierophant	Once/scene after successfully using a rite, grant a conscious willing ally in your zone 1 temporary Guard until scene end. Temporary Guard absorbs damage first, never stacks, and does not revive	Once/scene extend a protective rite with a duration until the end of your following turn instead of next turn. No range extension or extra target	Once/session perform a ten-minute communal observance in safety: all willing participants restore Conviction to 3. No influence or conversion effects
Freeblade	Once/scene on a successful weapon strike choose +1 damage or move one zone after resolving it; no extra attack	Once/scene react after a visible enemy misses you with an attack to move to one adjacent zone. Cannot also use another reaction that round	Once/session after a successful weapon strike prevent the target using its listed special action on its next turn; ordinary movement/attacks remain legal

Advancement through rank 10

Use chapter 3 milestones: four to buy each rank. No attribute above +3, no extra attack per turn, no new Conviction maximum. Rank 1 starts as normal. Ranks 2-5 remain chapter 3 except for these additions: rank 2 chooses Discipline; rank 4 learns second Vocation technique.

Rank	Gain
6	Discipline adept foundation +choose an adept elective; +1 maximum Guard
7	Choose one extra rite from your Pantheon's advanced list in chapter 7; add one expertise justified by training
8	Choose a second advanced rite from your Pantheon; +1 maximum Guard
9	Discipline master foundation +choose a master elective; no attribute increase
10	**Legacy:** once/session when you complete a significant mission objective, restore 1 Accord. Choose one: a modest ship module, an established sanctuary contact, or a workshop accessible as a home base. The base produces no free resources or automatic followers

At rank 10 base maximum Guard is 10 before wounds. Training, learning, social growth and new relics continue beyond rank 10 without automatic numerical increases. Do not promise infinite level scaling from this alpha.

09 / Pantheon-specific paths

Pantheons should change how characters play as well as which powers they name. At rank 3 choose **one Mantle**: a common Mantle from chapter 2 or a path belonging to your Pantheon below. This replaces that common choice; it is not a second free package. Each path has a rank-3 feature and rank-5 deepening. Keep its starting feature when deepened. No extra attribute, Conviction maximum or action is granted unless explicitly stated.

All nine paths are original tabletop designs under the three inspiration identities. They describe practices, not compulsory political factions or moral alignments. Either Aspect of a Pantheon may choose any of its paths. Any Lineage, Embodiment, Vocation and Discipline may combine with them. They do not require territorial play or a Zeal meter.

Order

Patternwright

You read relationships among people, machines and structures, then help others act on them.

Rank 3 - Shared Solution: once per scene, after you successfully use Measure the Fault, name a concrete task clock involving the revealed weakness. The next ally to make progress on that task before your next turn adds 1 progress. Outside rounds the benefit expires after the next risky group action. It never adds a second damage bonus or extra action.

Rank 5 - Contingency: when that bonus progress completes the task, regain 1 Conviction after its resolution, maximum 3. If no relevant extended task exists, you can instead give the next ally exploiting the weakness 1 temporary Guard before their roll; temporary Guard follows chapter 8's nonstacking rule.

At the table: a mechanical human Witness might analyze a failing airlock while a human Biotic Artificer fixes it. Patternwright doesn't turn the repair into worship or replace the repairer's action.

Network Steward

You make protection available to people who cannot all stand in the same place.

Rank 3 - Distributed Bastion: once per scene when using Bastion, replace its single-target reduction with a **2-point protection pool** shared by two named willing targets in your zone. Until your next turn, either target can spend pool points to reduce incoming damage, minimum 0. Each point prevents 1 damage; spending removes it from the shared pool. It cannot reduce one hit below 0 or stack with another Bastion on that target.

Rank 5 - Wider Net: the pool becomes 3 points, still at most two targets. You may name one target in an adjacent visible zone instead of both in your own. This does not add a new target to ordinary Bastion or increase the normal single-target reduction.

At the table: a devout soldier and a secular civic engineer can practice the same protective tradition while disagreeing about its explanation.

Severant

You interrupt a harmful connection rather than simply overpowering its user.

Rank 3 - Cut the Circuit: once per scene when successfully using Binding Line, replace movement restriction with preventing one named special action on the target's next turn. It may still move, make ordinary attacks and take other actions. You must identify an observed/listed action, not invent an undiscovered vulnerability. Choose this path only if you know Binding Line, or exchange your rank-2 unlock for it when selecting the Mantle.

Rank 5 - Clean Break: for the same once/scene use, after resolution you may take 1 Strain to impose both the normal movement restriction and the special-action restriction. Resolve Fracture after applying the effects. No effect extends beyond the stated duration or changes a person's beliefs.

Ancients

Trailweaver

You make a path usable by a group, not just its fastest member.

Rank 3 - Held Way: once per scene Living Path lasts through the end of your following turn instead of until your next turn. Name the safe connection when casting. It remains a traversal permission, not a new bridge across a void or through a sealed story barrier.

Rank 5 - Last Across: when you use Held Way, one conscious willing ally in your zone may immediately move across that connection if adjacent; it uses no action or normal move. At most one ally moves. The benefit doesn't allow an attack or carry an unwilling target.

Memorybearer

You carry evidence without pretending it is the whole truth.

Rank 3 - Witnessed Trace: once per scene after Star Witness reveals a hidden creature or active rite, record its observable signature. Until scene end, you can identify the same revealed creature/rite when seen again despite ordinary disguises or a changed emitter. You do not automatically locate it or see through opaque walls. Intelligent imitation may create an investigation rather than a false certainty.

Rank 5 - Shared Recognition: choose one willing companion who witnessed the revelation; they can recognize the signature too. In addition, once per session when a recorded signature genuinely changes an investigation's plan, restore 1 Accord, maximum 3. Repeatedly revealing the same harmless object is not a new discovery.

Lifetender

You preserve the ability to keep going without making recovery endless.

Rank 3 - Renewing Shelter: once per scene after Renewal restores Guard to a target, that target also clears 1 Strain. It still may benefit from Renewal only once per scene across all casters. Choose this path only if you know Renewal, or exchange your rank-2 unlock for it when selecting the Mantle.

Rank 5 - Safe Hand: after that use you may give the recipient your light-armor use if yours is still unused this scene and theirs is already spent. Mark yours spent; they gain one reduction of 1 before scene end. A heavy-shell user cannot turn this into a second heavy-shell reduction. No transfer if the recipient already has an unused armor use.

Divinity

Lamplighter

You help people act together under fear and uncertainty.

Rank 3 - Guiding Sanctuary: once per scene when casting Sanctuary, its target may move to an adjacent safe zone immediately. Sanctuary then applies as normal, including ending if that character attacks. This movement grants no attack or additional action.

Rank 5 - Companionship: the target may instead remain and give a conscious willing ally in their zone 1 temporary Guard until scene end. Choose the move or temporary Guard, not both. The normal Sanctuary target still receives its defense edge.

Veilward

You create room for refusal and escape, rather than making secrets a license to control people.

Rank 3 - Quiet Intervention: once per scene after successfully using Unmask, one willing ally in the affected zone clears 1 Strain. The rite must actually suppress an active effect; casting it at an empty wall does nothing. This does not remove a wound, revive someone or reveal private thoughts.

Rank 5 - Concealed Withdrawal: that ally may also immediately move one adjacent safe zone if conscious. They cannot attack or take another action as part of this movement. The suppressing rite retains its ordinary duration.

Thresholdkeeper

You help another person bear danger without claiming ownership of their choices.

Rank 3 - Shared Burden: once per scene when using Shared Breath, you may take just 1 Strain from the willing ally and give that ally 1 temporary Guard until scene end. You still take the transferred Strain and can suffer Fracture. This modifies the affinity, so costs no Conviction and still uses its action and once/scene limit.

Rank 5 - Steady Crossing: when you personally suffer Fracture from Shared Breath, the ally clears 1 additional Strain before your withdrawal or Guard loss resolves. No additional Strain transfers to you from this extra clearing. It occurs at most once per scene and cannot be triggered by moving Strain between cooperating characters repeatedly.

Changing paths and combining effects

Exchange your Mantle after a meaningful training/story change during safe downtime, no more than once per adventure. Lose the old features completely; keep rank, known rites and other packages. Changing Pantheon also requires exchanging the path for one legal in the new Pantheon or a common Mantle. An unused light-armor use, temporary Guard and a rite are separate resources, but two copies of the same named protection never stack.

For any ability triggered by an ally, “ally” means another willing character, not yourself. A retinue may receive protection or movement but cannot create repeated social/quest triggers. If two features would interrupt an event, resolve the acting player's reaction first, then other willing reactions in crew-chosen order; each unit still gets only one reaction per round.

10 / Armory and relics

Equipment should change what you can do or where you want to stand, without burying the game under numerical upgrades. These profiles expand chapter 5. A character can describe comparable technology from another civilization with the same rules; nobody's species grants exclusive access to a rifle, shield or laboratory.

Weapon profiles

At creation choose an ordinary damage-2 close or ranged profile at no extra cost, or a damage-1 nonlethal profile. Other gear requires its listed Supply and an actual supplier/salvage opportunity. A profile's special option replaces the stated normal benefit, not every benefit simultaneously. One exceptional strike grants one exceptional benefit; a weapon option cannot also add the usual +1 damage unless it says so.

Profile	Damage / reach	Cost	Distinct option / tradeoff
Boarding blade	2 / close	1, or starting weapon	On an exceptional hit, instead of a normal exceptional benefit, move yourself and a willing ally in your zone together to one adjacent safe zone. No forced enemy movement
Impact staff	2 / close	1, or starting weapon	When using the universal restrain action, can pin a human-scale target without rope if you remain in the same zone. Moving away ends that pin
Shock baton	1 / close	1, or starting weapon	Nonlethal: an NPC reduced to Guard 0 is safely incapacitated unless a separate hazard intervenes. On exceptional hit may instead disarm one ordinary held item
Compact sidearm	2 / ranged	1, or starting weapon	Can be carried discreetly in ordinary clothing; deliberate inspection can find it. This is concealability, not a roll bonus or a license to ignore local rules
Field carbine	2 / ranged	1, or starting weapon	Once/scene an exceptional suppression result may affect two enemies in the same visible zone. No damage; suppression's recovery window applies to both
Scatter projector	2 / own zone; 1 / adjacent visible zone	1, or starting weapon	Choose reach per attack. On an exceptional own-zone hit, may pin a human-scale target until your next turn instead of the usual exceptional benefit; ordinary damage still applies
Survey rifle	2 / ranged	2	After spending an action to Aim, may shoot up to two visible connections away before next turn ends. A blocked line still blocks. Moving or losing sight ends Aim; no free extra damage
Heavy projector	3 / ranged	2	Bulky: cannot move and fire on the same turn, including free extra movement. An ally moving you before your turn doesn't count as your turn's move

Profile	Damage / reach	Cost	Distinct option / tradeoff
Tether launcher	1 / ranged	2	On a hit choose damage OR a physical pin until your next turn, requiring a reachable anchor in the target's zone. Target can spend action to break free. No binding a ship or ignoring an anchored giant

All ranged weapons can target own/adjacent visible zones unless stated otherwise. A name doesn't create splash damage, armor penetration, mind control or ship-scale fire. A starting shield is one way to describe light armor's limited reduction, not an extra hidden armor bonus. Heavy shell uses chapter 5's once/scene reduction and mobility tradeoff.

Disarming and restraint: disarming an ordinary held item can use a plausible precise strike. Restraint needs physical means: close grappling, a staff hold, rope, tether, net or an appropriate rite. Shooting a normal sidearm does not automatically tie someone up. These options are available to every Vocation but require a plausible method.

Practical field technology

Tool	Cost	Use / limit
Rescue sled	1	Carry one willing or Downed person along an already traversable route without a Force roll; not a flying platform
Portable translator	1	Supports ordinary trade speech and stored languages; unfamiliar communication requires observation and research, not instant cultural understanding
Atmosphere tent	2	One watch's setup creates a safe air refuge for four adapted occupants where anchored and powered; recharge at ship/base. No radiation/pressure/weapon immunity
Remote sampler	1	Manipulate/collect a small physical sample in own/adjacent visible zone through a clear route; fragile, no attack, no hidden extra character turn
Biotic stabilizer	1/use	One action on an unconscious target in your zone stabilizes normally. It does not erase the stabilization wound, revive instantly or treat an old wound
Medical/repair ampoule	1/use	One action restores 2 Guard to a conscious willing target in your zone; select compatible medical or mechanical formulation when buying
Neural focus	2	A training aid/interpreter for psionic practice. Grants safe communication with a willing trained partner through an ordinary interface; no generic +1 or free additional psionic power
Signal decoy	1/use	Place a false ordinary radio signature in your/adjacent zone until scene end. Inspection/scan reveals a transmitter; it doesn't create a ship, false memories or guaranteed enemy behavior

Gear use is automatic when the ordinary task is unopposed. A tense deployment, guarded approach or unstable sample can require a normal action/roll with announced stakes. Specialized devices permit tasks; they don't guarantee research conclusions. Ten samples from the same unchanged source do not create ten new investigation rolls.

Relics: readied wonders

A relic has a known use, a cost, a limitation and an observable failure/counterplay condition. The crew can carry many recovered objects, but a character may have at most **two readied field relics** whose activations they can use. Change readied relics during ten safe minutes. This limit applies to field powers in this chapter and the activated relics in chapter 6; an ordinary archive used for research is not a power slot. A Memory Seed used to replay a record is an activated field relic; a copied chart is not.

Relics are adventure rewards, not a mandatory shop tier or a requirement to keep pace with damage scaling. Study can reveal what an object does without proving its divine origin. A weapon with a relic story still uses its declared damage profile unless a specific power says otherwise. No relic permanently adds to attributes or escapes the modifier cap.

Relic	Power	Cost / visible limit
Listening Prism	Separate one known voice from a noisy recording in your zone	Once/scene, action +1 Conviction; needs a genuine recording/trace. Cannot read a mind, fabricate deleted content or prove truth
Gravity Spindle	Move a willing conscious creature in your zone to one adjacent visible safe zone in zero/low gravity	Once/scene, action +1 Conviction; requires an unblocked path, no ship-scale force, target can't also attack as part of movement
Shelter Sigil	Two willing creatures in your zone tolerate one named ordinary environmental hazard until your next turn	Action +1 Conviction; no weapon, pressure, vacuum or ship-destruction protection. Visible field disappears if carrier is Downed
Horizon Glass	View the current public exterior of one known landmark on the same world or orbital system for a few moments	Once/session, ten minutes +1 Conviction +1 Strain; needs a prior visited/recorded landmark, blocked by shielding, no interior/private thought or interstellar targeting
Recall Cord	Retrieve an unattended hand-sized item you previously marked from an adjacent visible zone	Once/scene, action +1 Conviction; path must fit the item, a holder/lock prevents retrieval. Cannot steal an item from a person automatically
Waylight	Leave a luminous route marker readable through ordinary fog/darkness for one watch	Action +1 Conviction; enemies can read it too, and it reveals only a route you actually traversed. Destroying/moving the marker changes its usefulness
Resonance Key	After examining a powered non-sentient device for ten minutes, ask what ordinary input would place it in maintenance mode	Once/scene, +1 Conviction; answer may be a missing key/credential, not automatic bypass. Sentient beings are not devices for this purpose
Last Ember	When a willing ally in your zone would gain a wound bringing their total to 2 or 3, take that new wound yourself instead	Once/session reaction +1 Conviction; the ally remains otherwise Downed/affected normally. You may retire at three wounds; cannot transfer a historical wound or a consequence already resolved

Readied-power activation is still limited by the ordinary action/reaction rules. A reaction relic cannot be used after your reaction is spent. Gaining or discarding an object does not reset its once/session use. The Guide can record a relic's use by item as well as character when it changes hands; handoffs cannot farm free activations.

Making a relic together

Start with a scene the object should enable: safe crossing, communication, research, rescue, concealment or a distinctive tactical move. Give it one bounded effect comparable to an existing rite, one action/time cost, a Conviction/Strain/material cost where appropriate, and one way its opportunity can fail. Decide who made it and who wants it only after agreeing how it works. If it replaces an entire Vocation or solves every mystery, reduce its scope rather than hiding punitive side effects.

Three useful story questions: who previously relied on it; what did they misunderstand; what would returning it change? The answer can be joyful, practical, frightening or contested. Not every artifact is cursed and not every mystery ends in a god.

Personal fitting choices

Signature gear adds six fittings: one equipped weapon fitting and one field fitting, each costing 1 Supply to own. Safe swapping takes ten minutes without repeat payment. These are loadout options alongside the weapon profiles, with their own compatibility and tradeoffs.

12 / Discipline electives

Keep your Discipline's three foundation features from chapter 8. In addition, choose **one novice elective at rank 2**, **one adept elective at rank 6**, and **one master elective at rank 9** from that Discipline. Each choice is permanent until safe retraining. This gives a specialization its own decisions without making body, species or faith determine it. A new player can choose the first option in each tier as a usable default; there is no mandatory “correct” path.

Electives are class techniques, not rites, unless a specific rule modifies a rite. They do not trigger a Votary's rite refund by themselves. Costs are paid before the effect; a Fracture that makes you withdraw or become Downed interrupts an unresolved action and keeps its paid cost. A stated after-resolution cost happens after the effect. All attacks obey normal visibility, armor, damage order and situation caps. An “ally” is another willing character, not yourself.

Retraining: one safe downtime project plus a concrete teacher, practice opportunity or research source can exchange one elective for another of the same Discipline/tier. No buying temporary options in the middle of a scene. Changing the entire Discipline is a major story/training project: one adventure-scale commitment and a safe week, then exchange foundation features and all electives together. You never keep both complete packages.

Biotic

Novice - choose one

- **Tissue Knit:** action, appropriate medical/repair formulation, and 1 Strain restore 2 Guard to a conscious willing creature in your zone, including yourself. A recipient benefits from Tissue Knit only once per scene across all users. This is not Renewal, doesn't erase wounds and cannot revive a Downed target. Describe compatible biological or biosynthetic treatment; it needn't declare one body form inferior.
- **Morphic Armory:** use an action to shape or deploy an integrated close weapon for this scene. It deals 2 damage using Force or Presence; use ordinary strike outcomes. While deployed that limb/tool can't hold another item or operate delicate tools. Dismiss it freely on your turn. It grants no additional attack, reach, armor or hidden free hand. For a mechanical person this can be a cultivated modular interface rather than a rewritten ancestry.
- **Sensory Bloom:** once per scene, action to study a reachable biological sample or a visible living creature. Learn one observable fact: immediate toxic exposure, a physical injury, ordinary dormancy, or the sample's compatibility with a known environment. No hidden beliefs, universal diagnosis, entire species history or guaranteed cure. An unfamiliar organism may require research to interpret what you observe.

Adept - choose one

- **Adaptive Matrix:** when using your foundation's environmental adaptation, once per scene apply it to two willing targets in your zone instead of one. Each gets the same chosen adaptation and duration. It remains ordinary water/air tolerance, not vacuum, pressure or weapon immunity.
- **Recovery Catalyst:** once per scene after you restore Guard with an ability, spend 1 Supply to increase that restoration by 1. It does not reset the recipient's once/scene healing limits. The foundation's separate once/scene Strain-clearing benefit may apply to that restoration as normal.

Master - choose one

- **Life Bridge:** once per session, action +1 Supply +1 Strain to restore 2 Guard to a **stabilized Downed** willing target in your zone who has fewer than three wounds. Unlike ordinary healing, this explicitly lets them act again on their next eligible activation; it grants no immediate extra turn and removes no wound. If activation costs Down you or force withdrawal, it fails. A retired three-wound character still needs care and an agreed return.

- **Living Refuge:** once per session, spend ten safe minutes preparing up to four willing creatures with appropriate tools. For one watch they tolerate one named ordinary atmospheric/biological hazard already studied. The protection ends for someone who leaves the prepared environment; it doesn't stop vacuum, pressure, radiation, extreme heat, weapons or a new unidentified toxin. Supplies, sleep and research still matter.

Mechanist

Novice - choose one

- **Remote Platform:** deploy one non-sentient field drone (Guard 2, armor 0, damage 1 ranged). It has **no independent activation**. Your action can command it to move one zone and take one ordinary action; you cannot also attack/interact with that same action. Your normal personal move remains. You roll Insight for its attacks and Finesse for its defense. It cannot use rites, hold opinions for social farming, stabilize without an installed medical tool, or use character Conviction. At Guard 0 it is disabled; a safe watch and 1 Supply restore it. Only one platform per user, not a free army. At most one action per user per round still applies.
- **Integrated Rig:** action to deploy a close-range powered tool/weapon for the scene. It deals 2 damage and may use Insight for strikes. It occupies your hands/interface while active; you can't simultaneously wield another weapon or perform fine tool work through the rig. Stow freely on your turn. Damage, armor and partial/miss costs remain ordinary, and it adds no extra attack.
- **Overclock Sequence:** once per scene after a successful repair, survey or hacking task roll, take 1 Strain to add 1 progress. It cannot add damage, create a new fact or count as a second action. Resolve any Fracture **after** that progress is applied. A task must already exist and have meaningful stakes.

Adept - choose one

- **Field Fortification:** once per scene, action +1 Supply with tools place an ordinary opaque barrier at one reachable connection from your zone. It has Guard 3, armor 0; attacks or a plausible sabotage action can remove it. It blocks passage/sight until opened or broken; you can include a simple latch usable from your side. It cannot seal vacuum safely, appear around an unwilling target, or prevent every exit without an actual plan. A suitable alternate route remains a scene-design responsibility.
- **Emergency Tow:** once per scene use an action to have your foundation tool drone tow one willing or Downed person from your zone to an adjacent safe zone along an unblocked route. No automatic stabilization, attack or independent drone turn. The person must be physically supportable by available rigging, and the effect can't tow a ship.

Master - choose one

- **Linked Systems:** once per session, after a successful repair or hacking task roll, spend 1 Supply to add 2 progress. It can combine with Overclock Sequence if you chose it and pay that feature's cost, but cannot turn a task into a second attack. The fictional access and tools still must be present.
- **Last Deflector:** once per session react to a damaging hit against a willing creature in your zone, including yourself. Spend 1 Supply to reduce the hit by 3 after continuous armor, minimum 0. It uses your round's reaction and can't be applied after the final damage has already been recorded as a wound/retirement event.

Psion

Novice - choose one

- **Kinetic Bolt:** you can make a ranged strike using Insight, dealing 2 damage in your or an adjacent visible zone. It is a repeatable action, not a rite: no base Conviction cost and no special protection against armor. Use ordinary strike partial/miss costs. It cannot shoot through an opaque wall, read a target's mind, be overreached as a rite, or act at ship scale. A restraint or disarm still needs a physically plausible approach.
- **Thought Bridge:** once per scene, action +1 Strain to invite a brief willing exchange with one person you know is inside the current connected ship/building/site, up to three zones away even without sight. They may refuse or remain silent. It doesn't locate a stranger, read unwilling thoughts, cross interstellar space, translate all languages or prove sincerity. An active shielded zone can block the invitation.
- **Kinetic Brace:** once per scene, action +1 Strain to give one willing target in your zone, including yourself, reduction 2 against their next hit before your next turn. It does not stack with Bastion; the target chooses one of those reductions. Ordinary armor/temporary Guard still apply in damage order.

Adept - choose one

- **Redirection:** once per scene react after rolling your defense against a visible ranged attack but before applying damage. Reduce any remaining hit damage by 1 after continuous armor, minimum 0. This doesn't change the die result, grant an attack or prevent an independent hazard.
- **Open Sense:** once per scene use an action to invite known willing companions within the connected location (up to three zones) to indicate their position and one immediate need. Only responders reveal themselves; a refusal gives no location or proof of danger. Shielding blocks contact. This is a rescue/coordination tool, not a mass surveillance power.

Master - choose one

- **Steady Mind:** once per session when you suffer Fracture, reset Strain to 1 without withdrawing or losing Guard. Activation costs remain paid and already resolved effects remain. This is one explicit exception to the Fracture choice, not immunity to later stress.
- **Far Grasp:** your foundation's once/session human-sized obstruction shift may instead target an adjacent visible zone by paying 1 additional Strain. It still cannot move a living target, ship, sealed barrier or object without an unblocked route. Resolve activation Fracture before the effect.

Hierophant

Novice - choose one

- **Liturgical Focus:** once per scene after a hostile rite rolls 7-9, you may pay 1 additional Conviction to avoid the partial result's 1 Strain. You must have it available. It does not remove Radiant Debt's separate additional Strain, an overreach cost or any environmental consequence.
- **Open Invocation:** once per scene after successfully using a friendly rite on another willing creature, that creature gains an edge on their next relevant roll before the end of their next turn (or next risky group action outside rounds). Normal situation cap applies. It grants no immediate action or automatic extra target.
- **Counterchant:** once per scene, action +1 Strain to interrupt one visible active rite affecting your/adjacent zone. Roll Presence: 7+ suppress it until your next turn; 7-9 also gain 1 Strain; 6- no suppression and gain 1 Strain. This technique is not itself a rite and doesn't suppress technology, intrinsic bodies, permanent relic nature or beliefs. A physical/ritual interruption needs visible access, not naming an enemy god.

Adept - choose one

- **Ready Chorus:** once per scene, after you spend your action Helping another person's rite and they resolve it successfully before your next turn, regain 1 Conviction, maximum 3. Help's normal expiry/cap applies. You cannot Help yourself or trigger it from an unchanged trivial practice repeatedly.
- **Grounding Response:** once per scene react when a willing ally in your zone suffers Fracture. If they choose Guard loss, reduce that loss from 2 to 1; if they choose withdrawal, they may immediately make one ordinary move toward safety. Their lost actions/reactions remain lost and Strain still resets to 1. It does not prevent the Fracture or transfer their choice to you.

Master - choose one

- **Shared Overreach:** once per session when overreaching a rite, a willing ally in your zone may take 1 of the 2 activation Strain instead of you. Each resolves any resulting Fracture before the rite. If either required participant is Downed/withdraws before it resolves, the overreached effect fails with costs spent. No coercing another person's resources.
- **Unbroken Vigil:** once per session react when a protective rite you cast would expire solely because its duration ends. Extend it for one additional round, or one additional risky group action outside rounds. Its ordinary ending conditions still apply: Sanctuary ends on attacking, and Quiet Passage ends on movement or attacking. It doesn't extend an instant heal or grant a second activation.

Freeblade

Novice - choose one

- **Measured Shot:** once per scene spend your move lining up Aim instead of spending your action. You do not change zones with that move; your action may fire as normal. Aim's edge/range conditions still apply, and a heavy projector can fire because you didn't actually move zones. No additional attack or damage bonus beyond the normal edge.
- **Guarded Strike:** once per scene after a successful close strike, you may immediately take cover at an actual available position in your zone without an extra action. Cover applies after the strike, so it remains until you next move or attack. No cover materializes in an empty corridor.
- **Breach Rhythm:** once per scene replace your move with forcing one ordinary reachable unsecured hatch/door open, using Force if opposition makes it uncertain. You may then use your action normally. A reinforced vault, active defender or major task can't be erased by calling it a door. Partial/failure uses the announced force-entry consequence.

Adept - choose one

- **Tactical Switch:** once per scene after a successful weapon strike, you and a conscious willing ally in an adjacent zone may exchange zones through an unblocked safe route. No extra attack/action; incompatible gravity or a sealed barrier prevents the swap. Resolve the strike before movement.
- **Hard Landing:** once per scene your normal move may cross one known rough-ground or human-scale gap hazard without its routine roll if you describe a plausible landing/anchor. It cannot cross an abyss, vacuum without protection, a sealed wall or a separately hostile zone effect. It doesn't add a second move.

Master - choose one

- **Decisive Advance:** once per session when your foundation's master strike suppresses an enemy special action, two conscious willing allies in your zone may immediately move one zone each along safe open routes. They cannot attack or take other actions as part of this movement. The enemy still gets ordinary actions.

- **Last Stand:** once per session when you would be Downed, gain 1 wound and remain at Guard 1 instead. This is your reaction for the round. If that wound reaches three you still retire from the scene; the power doesn't cancel retirement or remove earlier harm. You must be conscious before the triggering hit and cannot use it repeatedly at Guard 0.

Learning the choices through play

Read only your Discipline's novice options at rank 2. The adept/master tiers can wait. Pair a choice with a concrete scene you want to be good at: a Psion's Kinetic Bolt supports direct action, Thought Bridge supports contact/rescue, and Kinetic Brace supports protection. None changes your species, body or religion. A mechanical human of Ancients can be a Biotic Freeblade; a gene-crafted human of Order can be a Psion Envoy.

The offline companion summarizes the foundations and electives, but the table still resolves willingness, tools, range, damage, scene refreshes and consequences. No elective makes a person a terminal or turns a Pantheon into a compulsory political faction.

13 / Wonders and discoveries

Lantern Reach should leave the crew with stories and strange tools, not only a paid invoice. Before an expedition, prepare one **wonder** that changes a possible approach: an impossible refuge, a folded bridge, a living map or an object that turns a past promise into something present. Put a visible sign of it in at least two reachable places. Players can investigate, leave it, share it or take responsibility for it.

A field wonder is a relic and counts toward the normal **two readied relics per explorer**. Study its behavior for ten safe minutes before use unless its entry requires longer; identify its actual use and limits before a player commits. This chapter's six named wonders use **one shared activation per physical object per expedition**. Passing the object to another person, changing who readies it or beginning a new scene/session does not refresh it. Record the use on the object card; it renews only when the crew completes/abandons the undertaking and reaches genuine safe resupply/downtime.

These are adventure rewards, not compulsory purchases or universal mass-produced equipment. Activation costs below are explicit; do not additionally charge the ordinary rite cost. They are automatic if their conditions are met, so cannot be Pushed. An interrupted long activation spends its costs under core rules. Strong new permissions are intentional: tell players what the wonder **can** do before discussing unusual edge cases.

Pocket Dawn

A hand-sized lantern opens like a miniature sunrise. **Action +1 Conviction:** anchor a breathable ordinary-pressure refuge around up to four compatible willing occupants in your zone for one watch, including in ordinary vacuum. They may breathe, speak, work and stabilize casualties inside. The refuge has a visible boundary, stays anchored and fits an ordinary room-sized zone; entry/exit is possible. It provides no weapon protection or treatment and cannot hold a moving ship together. The targetable lantern has Guard 3, armor 0. At 0 the refuge ends after one clearly announced round, giving occupants time to act. Ordinary compatible lighting/air are included; extreme planetary pressure, radiation and incompatible biology require their own preparations.

Discovery: its glow outlines breath on the inside of an abandoned exterior window. A stranded maintenance worker knows the unfolding gesture. **Decision it creates:** spend the expedition's refuge here, or preserve it for a deeper crossing? **Connection:** the maker's service mark identifies a reachable refuge network that wants the lantern used, not locked in a collector's cabinet.

Bridgefold

A metal ribbon unfolds into a luminous lattice. **Action +1 Conviction +1 Strain:** create one traversable human-scale bridge across a visible gap between your zone and one adjacent visible zone until scene end. It needs a reachable secure anchor at both ends; the second can be reached by an ordinary tether/tool. Up to two human-scale creatures cross at once using ordinary movement. This is a real new connection, not an extra move or teleport. The bridge has Guard 4, armor 0 if attacked; at 0 it folds away after a visible warning, allowing occupants one reactionless move to a safe end if one is reachable. It does not supply air, conceal travelers or support a vehicle.

Discovery: its folded shape appears in a scratched route sketch and a blocked shaft's maintenance label. **Decision:** open a direct rescue route that enemies can also use, or keep the obstacle intact? **Connection:** returning the ribbon's survey log introduces a cartographer who can chart one further lead.

Tideglass

A shell filled with slowly moving light. **Ten-minute preparation +1 Conviction:** one conscious willing wearer breathes ordinary water and tolerates the local pressure of one established shallow/deep inhabited worksite for a watch. Establish the site's usable depth with the Guide before committing; it cannot descend indefinitely. It also permits clear ordinary conversation with another compatible Tideglass-equipped listener in the same zone. It does not grant swimming speed, armor, poison immunity or survival in vacuum. At expedition use end it becomes an ordinary warm shell until refreshed.

Discovery: a diver's visible breathing trail leads to an intact shelter, and their log describes the shell. **Decision:** who gets to reach the submerged controls while the others hold the route? **Connection:** the diver's cooperative asks for an account of the route, opening a real working relationship rather than an automatic ownership claim.

Promise Engine

A compact mechanical heart repeats a phrase recorded by its maker. **One minute +1 Conviction:** power one intact ordinary human-scale utility in your zone for a watch without its normal local supply: a door motor, water pump, lift controller or treatment lamp. It can run only one named device and must remain physically connected. Its visible hum identifies the circuit; disconnecting it ends the effect. It cannot fire a weapon, recharge another relic, create Stores or move a whole ship. It can make a lift or pump function when every ordinary wire is dead.

Discovery: an unpowered bell still rings a recorded maintenance promise; a nearby service diagram names the matching socket. **Decision:** spend its one run on access, rescue or preserving a sample? **Connection:** the original promise names a person or community whose unfinished work can become a personal thread.

Orchard of Echoes

A small branch grows translucent leaves that catch different angles of light. **Ten minutes +1 Conviction at a reachable site:** preserve one genuine current scene as a room-sized interactive light record that willing viewers can inspect for a watch while the branch stays planted. The Guide distinguishes visible facts, interpretations and missing information. Viewers can walk around recorded visible objects and compare marks; hidden interiors and unperceived details remain missing. The branch can later be uprooted intact, but the projection then ends. It does not determine truth, extract thoughts or replay an unrecorded past.

Discovery: living leaves reproduce the crew's own arrival in miniature, and a local child knows how to plant the cutting. **Decision:** preserve evidence, make a public memorial or leave a comprehensible route model for the next travelers? **Connection:** a willing witness can use the record in a dispute, with their own interpretation and wishes intact.

Homeward Thread

A braided cord hums when its two end-knots approach. **One minute +1 Conviction:** designate one physical knot at a safe refuge you actually reached this expedition. Until expedition end, the readied carrier can sense its direction and whether the next traversable connection along their own previously traveled route still leads toward it, within the same site. When danger changes that route, the cord indicates the blocked connection rather than inventing passage. Its one activation persists; subsequent readings during the expedition are not new activations. It cannot cross sealed walls, locate an unvisited home or teleport. It does make a frightening retreat possible through darkness and misleading signs.

Discovery: an old route marker carries the matching weave; a traveler in the refuge recognizes its song. **Decision:** which refuge becomes the crew's real point of return? **Connection:** leave the anchor knot with a named willing host who expects a future visit, a report or a story rather than automatic tribute.

Place the wonder in play

For the first few adventures offer at most one new field wonder per expedition. Sharing a useful object is a crew decision, not a private competition to loot first. At least one use should be apparent in the current adventure, and at least one should invite a later expedition. Ordinary payment remains: do not replace a promised wage after the fact with an object the crew never agreed to accept.

Adventure	Where to reveal it	Immediate possibility
The Silent Berth	Rask's emergency locker; its label also appears on a hostel checklist	Pocket Dawn provides refuge along the exterior maintenance route or a reserve for later rescue
The Glass Orchard	A visible sealed survey cache near the terrace rim, described by the researchers	Tideglass opens an ordinary submerged survey route after safe preparation
The Broken Beacon	Refuge workers' tool crate, also marked on the lift diagram	Promise Engine can run the intact lift without repairing its feed
The Prism Vault	A clearly cataloged unclaimed travel locker beside the requested case	Bridgefold can cross a damaged service gap or become a later expedition tool
Hunt Beneath the Salt Crown	A survivor's known refuge kit offered in thanks, never looted from a living person	Homeward Thread makes the Cave a navigable return point
The Harbor Inside the World	A living record cutting freely offered by Habitation after consent	Orchard of Echoes gives residents a shared visible account of the repaired worksite

The Guide adds these placements as part of the revised reward guidance. A wonder that supplies an alternate route does not also complete unrelated task clocks. Its connection should open a playable relationship or question. Reward curiosity with a concrete fact before asking for another research roll.

14 / Signature gear and crew

This chapter adds personal loadout choices and a short crew interlude to the core game. It uses Supply, ordinary actions and Accord. Any Lineage, body, Pantheon or Vocation may use the gear. Name a favorite item, describe who made it and decide what you have changed. A sacred inscription, a grown housing, a mechanical interface or a psionic calibration can describe the same fitting without changing its rules.

Build a signature loadout

You may have **one weapon fitting and one field fitting equipped**, in addition to normal equipment and your existing two readied relic slots. A fitting occupies only its listed fitting slot. It never occupies both or grants an extra attack. Ordinary unfitted equipment remains useful.

Each fitting costs **1 Supply** from a plausible supplier or workshop. Buying gives permanent ownership of that individual fitting. Fitting, removing or swapping owned gear takes ten peaceful minutes with ordinary tools, not a downtime project. There is no repeat purchase cost for swapping. This time cannot be hidden between combat turns. A fitted item cannot be lent to several people at once; move the physical item and take the fitting time. Duplicated labels do not create additional copies. Spare owned fittings are equipment, not saleable Supply on demand.

Weapon fittings below fit an ordinary **damage-2 ranged weapon**. They do not fit bulky, damage-1 nonlethal, close, natural or rite attacks. Choose a fitting rather than combining them on one weapon. Named weapon-profile rules still apply; the same range permission never stacks with itself. Field fittings work with any weapon or body. Their effect is applied manually from the declared situation, not automatically to every roll.

Fitting	Slot	What changes	Tradeoff / limit
Anchor stock	Weapon	Before firing, declare a planted shot: ignore the shot's hindrance from ordinary target cover	You cannot move at any time during that turn, including free movement or an ally's movement effect. If already moved, no planted shot. It does not see through opaque barriers, ignore other hindrances or add a dice bonus. You may instead make an ordinary mobile shot with normal cover rules
Close-assault grip	Weapon	A ranged strike against someone in your own zone may use Force instead of Finesse	Adjacent-zone shots still use Finesse. No damage increase, extra strike, forced movement or ranged expertise bonus. It does not make a shooting attack into a physical grapple
Survey optic	Weapon	After spending an action to Aim, you may shoot a visible target two connected zones away before your next turn ends	Moving or losing sight ends Aim. The ordinary Aim edge still uses the single situation slot. No shooting through walls or stacking a Survey rifle into three-zone reach
Line reel	Field	Use an action to anchor a traverse line across one visible adjacent connection with real attachment points; it supports one human-scale traveler at a time	The line makes a physically possible gap crossing traversable. It cannot penetrate a wall, cross an unbounded gulf or move a ship. Deployment and retrieval each take an action; you must retrieve it to deploy elsewhere. A supported traveler uses their normal move, not a free move

Fitting	Slot	What changes	Tradeoff / limit
Rescue harness	Field	On your action, secure one willing or stabilized Downed human-scale person in your zone. You may carry them with your ordinary moves along traversable connections, including ladders with usable anchors	While loaded, you cannot attack, Sprint or use a bulky weapon; your actions can still work reachable controls or release the harness. No stabilization, healing, extra move, vacuum protection or carrying someone beyond your equipment's stated physical capacity
Sample vault	Field	An action places up to three human-portable samples in individually sealed compartments. Ordinary samples survive a watch of vacuum or the sampled site's ordinary atmospheric contamination	It does not protect occupants, permit handling an unknown sample safely, stop extreme pressure/heat/radiation, or make a biological sample universally harmless. Taking a sample remains an interaction with its real hazards; its preservation is automatic once safely sealed

A field fitting provides its listed protection or transport while equipped; unpack or release it safely before swapping. Removing a fitting never erases ownership. Changing weapon type leaves an incompatible fitting unequipped. Purchased fittings and found fittings use the same slot and effect. A fit is not an additional source of Conviction, an automatic task success or an exception to Fracture. Push may enhance a legal fitted strike normally; the fitting does not change Push's cost.

Make choices together

Before departure, each player can state one useful capability and one thing they would like an ally to handle. This can take one sentence. Share enough practical information to plan a combination; backstory revelations may remain for play. No optimal composition or compulsory tank/healer is required.

Examples: Taren uses a close-assault grip to defend a crowded boarding zone using Force; Neri's line reel creates a traversable escape connection that Taren can use on a later ordinary move. Cal's sample vault brings an intact organism home while Esra negotiates access to a laboratory. A player can swap their owned fitting next expedition after seeing which approach the crew enjoyed.

Find upgrades, not just invoices

Put an actual fitting at a visible discovery site, with its owner, practical use and terms of transfer. A reward can offer **one fitting instead of 1 Supply of an announced salvage payment**, with the crew choosing. Do not silently reduce an already promised contract reward. A workshop pattern is a future source: it lets a reachable workshop reproduce that fitting for its normal 1 Supply; it is not an infinite item printer.

Placement	Discoverable gear	Immediate reason to care
The Silent Berth	**Rask's rescue harness**, labeled in the Hostel locker	Loaned for the rescue; securing one resident takes an action, carrying follows the normal move. After the job, Rask offers permanent ownership for 1 Supply or a named future rescue favor that the crew may refuse
The Glass Orchard	**Kelm's sample vault**, listed on their field manifest	Kelm offers a loan if the crew agrees to return it with one shared sample. It can keep a properly collected sample viable during the trip; no automatic solution to an unknown biological hazard

Placement	Discoverable gear	Immediate reason to care
The Hanging Observatory field situation	**Iona's survey optic**, visible in her spare-tool case	Iona offers it in place of 1 Supply of the commissioning payment if the crew accepts joint credit. The normal route lead remains; the paid reward changes only by agreement

Name the physical object and record who owns it. Borrowed gear goes back when promised; breaking that promise changes the particular relationship. A found fitting does not require buying it a second time. Safe study/fitting time still applies.

Between the stars

At a safe voyage interval or after an expedition, invite a short scene between two willing crew characters. Each answers one prompt, in first person or a brief summary. Passing is always fine. For duet, the Guide may voice a willing companion; the player can answer in a short summary. This is ordinary conversation, not a compulsory religion scene or a substitute for rest, recovery or a downtime project.

- What did you see your crewmate do that changed how you understand them?
- What will you trust them with next time?
- What harmless ritual, meal, game or repair habit has become part of life aboard?
- What do you want this ship to become, and who do you hope will visit it?
- What do you want to ask about their tradition, body or home, if they want to share?
- What souvenir from the last expedition deserves a place aboard?

Write one shared memory, a current promise or a physical keepsake on the crew sheet. It can matter later through an invitation, recognized name or personal quest. It grants no automatic obedience or flat roll bonus.

Accord from a shared experience

Expand the existing **once-per-session shared Accord recovery**: regain 1 Accord, maximum 3, after either a negotiated sacrifice, a risky rescue outside the crew, **or** this willing crew scene about a concrete joint risk or meaningful discovery since the last such recharge. For the crew-scene option, the participants name what happened and one way it changes their trust or next intention. Inventing a repetitive declaration with no new shared experience does not qualify. The three options share **one** session limit; they are not three separate recoveries.

The scene may be peaceful. It need not manufacture an argument or require personal disclosure. It restores no Guard, Strain, Supply, Stores or Conviction. Starting a new room, expedition, safe rest or scene does not reset this Accord use. Only an actual new session resets it, alongside the normal start-of-session minimum of 2 Accord. If Accord is already 3, enjoy the conversation without spending its mechanical claim. Other explicit sources, such as the rank-10 Legacy feature, keep their own limits.

Example: after surviving the observatory's failing cable together, Neri says she trusts Taren to choose the next dangerous crossing. Taren says he will ask for her route judgment before committing the crew. They mount a bent brake handle in the mess. If the session's shared recovery is unused and Accord is 1, it becomes 2. Moving to the next port cannot grant another recovery from the same story.

Setting I / The Lantern Reach

Everything in this region is proposed tabletop material. It is not an assertion about approved planetary geography, chronology, FTL metaphysics or the location of Halden. Order, Ancients and Divinity retain their source identities; named gods and Prophets do not appear with invented official agendas.

The Reach is a small inhabited route network where old installations, working ports and newly surveyed worlds meet. People make a living through transport, clinics, salvage, research, manufacturing, hospitality and ordinary trade. The religious landscape is visible but varied: a cargo dock has a shrine beside a secular rescue office; a mechanical navigator records an ancestor's song; a gene-clinic shares a wall with an interfaith meal hall.

Route map

One connection is one leg unless marked otherwise. Routes are bidirectional. Stores costs follow chapter 6. The local map is deliberately small enough to explore rather than a claim of galaxy scale.

From	To	Known route / alternative
Meridian Anchorage	Saint's Wake Station	One safe leg; includes a reliable rescue channel
Meridian Anchorage	Kestrel's Garden	Two safe legs via a service buoy; one risky leg through dust (navigation hazard)
Saint's Wake Station	Kestrel's Garden	One leg; atmospheric approach needs a current scan
Kestrel's Garden	Quiet Glass	One surveyed leg; no public fuel at destination
Meridian Anchorage	Quiet Glass	Two legs; optional patrol encounter announced before departure

Meridian Anchorage

A working port with repair slips, adaptable habitats and elected berth councils. Humans are numerous and visibly diverse: unmodified traders, gene-crafted workers, augmented rescue crews and mechanical continuants live alongside several nonhuman communities. Major decisions are political, religious and economic rather than species-unanimous.

Facilities: refueling, ordinary gear, repair yard, clinic, three Pantheon gathering places, secular hostels. **Contact:** Jun Tal, an unmodified human ship registrar who follows Ancients and wants fewer abandoned wrecks. **Problem:** a charter dispute leaves a volunteer rescue ship impounded. **Leads:** a station distress job; a biological survey; a missing pilgrim's route records.

Saint's Wake Station

A mixed secular/religious transfer station with freight, clinics and a pilgrim hostel. It is not a temple ruled by one faith. Its name comes from a disputed rescue story; different communities interpret the “saint” differently. Many residents simply like the food stalls and cheap dock rent.

Facilities: emergency Stores, limited repairs, hostel. **Contact:** Administrator Lio Rask, a mechanical human and Divinity lay observer, currently overloaded by a power failure. **Problem:** a salvage lien threatens residents during a shutdown. **Adventure:** The Silent Berth.

Kestrel's Garden

A surveyed world with shallow saline seas, huge mineral terraces and a small mixed research settlement. Neither the planet nor its native life is a reward to be claimed without consequences. No intelligent native species is established by this first scenario; biological samples remain ethically and scientifically significant.

Facilities: shelter, laboratory, one landing pad; no full shipyard. **Contact:** Dr. An Varo, a human Biotic researcher, secular and skeptical of the sponsor's patents. **Problem:** a resonating artifact changes local growth and is interfering with sensors. **Adventure:** The Glass Orchard.

Quiet Glass

A cold abandoned observatory with a functioning narrow-band transmitter. Its makers and religious meaning are unknown. The keyed adventure establishes a malfunctioning rescue-pattern array, a missing expedition, and physical evidence; its conclusions do not require declaring any Pantheon correct.

Facilities: emergency shelter only after securing power. **Contacts:** the sheltered expedition members in the keyed adventure. **Problems:** privacy-compromising rebroadcasts, a power feedback loop, incomplete records and a hazardous energetic impression. **Adventure:** Quiet Glass.

A three-adventure opening arc

1. **The Silent Berth:** earn a ship's first rescue reputation while solving a station emergency. Recover a damaged survey record and a lead to Kestrel's Garden.
2. **The Glass Orchard:** investigate alien ecology and an artifact, resolve a recovery contract and decide who can study it. Find an observatory coordinate.
3. **Quiet Glass:** use the station's archive, the research sponsor or a rescued person to reach a complete observatory mystery. Rescue the expedition, understand the Return Array and decide what to preserve or share. Its route records lead into the wider society dossiers.

Between missions offer secular work, religious activity, personal quest scenes and bodily transformation as equal downtime options. The groundside Unclaimed Crossing can occur on an inhabited world as a standalone side adventure; it is not required to introduce space travel.

Setting II / Peoples and civilizations

These societies and homeworlds are **new tabletop proposals**, not recovered Manifest Destiny canon. A species is not a government. Individuals travel, migrate, adopt traditions and disagree; mixed families and communities are normal. Biological traits never dictate a person's morality, profession or political loyalty.

Humanity: many ways of being

Human societies in the Reach trace several migrations, research partnerships and commercial routes rather than one unified empire. Unmodified, gene-crafted, augmented, mechanical and psionically attuned humans may live in the same apartment block. Some communities organize around shared bodily experience, but no body grants automatic membership or agreement.

Meridian Anchorage's Civic Compact administration includes Ancients navigators, Order infrastructure councils, Divinity hospices and secular labor associations. The Helix Cooperative's patient-owned clinics compete with commercial gene houses; both contain sincere believers and skeptics. The Continuance Guild campaigns for reconstructed persons' inheritance rights while its chapters disagree on memory duplication. Quiet Reach schools teach consent-based psionic practice, with scientific and contemplative traditions side by side. Open Passage transport crews include religious pilgrims and secular rescue volunteers.

Live dispute: an old charter recognizes biological signatures as proof of identity. A mechanical human can own a business under newer law but cannot access a predecessor's ship under the old clause. Three possible approaches: legal evidence, recovering the missing original contract, or persuading the charter assembly to revise its rule. Hacking the registry alone cannot settle public recognition.

Ordinary life: dockside food exchanges, sports in variable gravity, borrowed holiday customs, gene-clinic graduation parties, mechanical artists composing for tactile instruments, households whose members practice different faiths. Show these between crises so humanity is more than its faction leaders.

Veyran societies: the Resonant Commons

Proposed origin world: Serev. Dense stone habitats and deep connected foundations favored communication through shared structures as well as speech. Echo Sense is a limited biological sense, not telepathy or a compulsory communal mind. Deaf, isolated, differently sensing and spaceborn Veyrans participate through other interfaces. There is no biological obligation to share private experience.

The **Resonant Commons** is a federation of habitat councils that maintains common transit foundations, archives and emergency shelter. A separate **Open Span League** argues that shared structures should not imply shared records. Commercial habitat houses operate outside both. Human and other residents can join councils on equal terms; Veyran emigrants need not identify with any of them.

Religious diversity: Ancients memorial galleries preserve personal accounts, Order schools maintain shared structures, Divinity observances use silence and touch. Secular civic traditions treat these as personal choices. No tradition speaks through all Veyrans.

Visitor custom: before a formal meeting the host identifies public and private channels. Newcomers may ask which surfaces carry civic signals; accidentally tapping a table is not a declaration of war. A translator or informed host explains conventions without a skill tax.

Conflict: a foundation sensor network could improve disaster warning but expose private movement. Archivist **Tel Varo** supports opt-in records; council engineer **Sesh Am** wants emergency access with clear oversight; courier **Rin** distrusts

both. A crew can survey a dangerous fault, design a limited sensor agreement, or discover a contractor selling data. No persuasion roll decides the whole society's privacy policy.

Adventure site: a transit hall evacuated years ago is broadcasting a current rescue pulse. Physical evidence may show malfunction, stranded travelers or an unauthorized archive-not automatically an ancient god.

Oruun societies: the Hearth Fleets

Proposed origin: migrating habitats descended from settlements around Tal Oss. Oruun populations include long-settled planetary communities and traveling fleets, each with internal language, politics and faith. Their Anchor Frame supports one limited resistance to forced movement; it does not make them universally strong, slow, militaristic or naturally suited to servitude.

The **Hearth Fleets** maintain a mutual-aid compact of ships and ports. Membership is by accepted rescue obligations, not ancestry. The **Stationary Assembly** prefers long-term habitat investment; the **Far Wake** captains push outward exploration; independent ports oppose the fleets' inspection rules. A human captain can command a Hearth ship, and an Oruun entrepreneur can reject the compact entirely.

Religious diversity: Order ceremonies recognize maintained life-support systems; Ancients families recount routes and remembered harbors; Divinity congregations host arrivals and departures. Several fleets use wholly secular rescue covenants. Clergy and engineers may be the same person, different people or openly disagree.

Visitor custom: a guest is offered an explicit length of hospitality so nobody mistakes kindness for an indefinite debt. Gifts are not compulsory. Habitats provide adaptable seating and suits as ordinary infrastructure.

Conflict: a drifting habitat requests rescue while carrying a restricted energy experiment. Captain **Ora Kel** insists residents come first; engineer **Beren Taal** fears towing the experiment will endanger the fleet; negotiator **Jema Oss** seeks a place to unload safely. Rescue, technical isolation and a new harbor agreement are all valid objectives. A decision to help one side does not make all Oruun allies or enemies.

Adventure site: a derelict Hearth vessel returns under automatic drive with every lifeboat missing and its galley recently used. Establish evidence before choosing an explanation.

Nacrean societies: the Littoral Cities

Proposed origin world: Pelara. Inland and ocean settlements are linked by amphibious transport, but neither geography nor biology produces one universal culture. Nacreans can live in dry stations, underwater districts or mixed habitats. Amphibious breathing does not grant immunity to pressure, pollutants or exhaustion.

The **Littoral Exchange** is a network of elected port councils handling water access and shared navigation. The **Deepward Universities** research old structures and challenge commercial extraction; the **Free Basins** favor local autonomy. Members of all Lineages live in these cities; access law and citizenship are political questions rather than genetic tests.

Religious diversity: Ancients sites tend living archives, Order communities maintain common floodworks, Divinity groups study transitions between environments, and secular neighborhood associations run many public services. One flooded shrine may be a museum, another an active religious place, another both.

Visitor custom: hosts publish the physical conditions of a meeting-air, water, temperature and access-before attendance. A dry audience has no lesser civic standing. Negotiation pauses for translation rather than treating breathing needs as a test of sincerity.

Conflict: an extraction license near an old floodworks threatens both a neighborhood and a research site. Biologist **Nema** seeks a pause for samples, port delegate **Kes II** needs jobs and repair revenue, diver **Anri** knows a safer route to the

deposit. Crew choices include research, engineering, public negotiation or exposing a false survey. Nobody needs to "civilize" the residents.

Adventure site: water recedes from a long-submerged interchange, exposing functioning machinery and two different histories carved into its walls. The mystery can lead to disputed migration records, alien technology or an environmental system; none is assumed in advance.

Add them to the route map

These are optional expansion destinations. Each has one surveyed two-leg passage from Meridian Anchorage, publicly available fuel and ordinary landing facilities. Tal Oss instead has a moving Hearth rendezvous with published coordinates; a successful contact gives its current position without a mandatory roll. Their first encounter can be cultural or commercial rather than a hostile "first contact." Uncharted neighboring worlds can use chapter 6's first-contact procedure.

Destination	Immediate job	Known reward	Local resource
Serev	Survey the sealed transit hall	4 Supply, archive introduction	Civic engineering library
Tal Oss rendezvous	Help isolate a dangerous cargo before towing	3 Supply, 2 Stores	Fleet repair dock
Pelara	Verify competing extraction surveys	4 Supply, licensed research access	Dive/pressure equipment supplier

These are developed society dossiers and job seeds, not three fully keyed adventures. Reach them through play when the crew wants a wider campaign. Canon reconciliation remains a separate editorial task; do not silently elevate these names to approved franchise geography.

Setting III / Gods and observances

This is **original mythology for this tabletop game's Lantern Reach**, inspired by the broad Order, Ancients and Divinity identities. These divine figures and stories are not claims about Manifest Destiny / ROZ's established gods or the nature of its Prophets. The owner has authorized independent expansion. Tables may use the stories as sincere religious traditions, contested history or encounters with actual divine beings without declaring all other interpretations false.

Pantheon is the character's primary sacred tradition. A person may honor several figures within it and attend another community's celebrations. Gods are not balanced combat opponents; meeting a presence creates a situation, a question and a choice. It doesn't require a stat block that explains the universe.

Order: the Assembly of Works

Regional Order communities tell of a universe in which things become habitable through shared, revisable work. Their divine stories disagree about whether the gods created the first tools or learned from those who used them. The three figures below form a common Reach grouping, not a universal ecclesiastical constitution.

The Cartographer of Returns

Concern: journeys, honest maps, mutual obligations and safe arrival. **Sign:** an open curve returning toward a small square; a map that deliberately leaves its border unfinished. **Offering:** a corrected chart, a rescue coordinate, a route made usable by someone else.

Story: a navigator promised that every traveler could find home. The stars changed, the first map failed, and the promise became an obligation to keep revising the map rather than blaming those who got lost. Some versions call the Cartographer divine from the beginning; others say the first worshippers made an ordinary navigator into a sacred memory.

Ordinary practice: before departure a crew records a return contact and names someone who should be told if it is late. Holy days can be public chart exchanges with music and rescued travelers' stories. Secular rescue offices often participate without affirming the story.

Disagreement: does a safe route belong to whoever paid to chart it, or to everyone who might need it? Devotees include surveyors, protective soldiers and skeptical registrars. A bad institution can claim the Cartographer's name to monopolize transit; that is an adventure problem, not the faith's universal doctrine.

The Joined Hand

Concern: repair, collaborative craft, bodily change and the dignity of unfinished people. **Sign:** two differently shaped hands holding the same tool; mechanical and organic hands are equally ordinary representations. **Offering:** repaired equipment returned to its user, a skill taught, consent obtained before altering a body.

Story: when a vessel broke, no single artisan could repair it. The Joined Hand appeared wherever two workers admitted what they could not do alone. Some depict one being with many arms, others a crowd or a workshop with nobody at its center.

Practice: apprentices name their teachers publicly; clinics celebrate a patient's chosen recovery milestone rather than a prescribed ideal body. Mechanical continuants and gene-crafted humans disagree with unmodified humans within the same temples, but none is excluded by biology.

Disagreement: who is responsible when a useful innovation harms someone later? Some schools emphasize public standards, others local consent and repair rights. An adventure might recover a cure while challenging the contract that makes it inaccessible.

The Unfinished Judge

Concern: evidence, accountable authority and the possibility of revision. **Sign:** an empty chair beside an open record. **Offering:** a correction made publicly at personal cost; safe access to an appeal.

Story: asked to pronounce the last perfect judgment, the Judge left a chair empty for the person nobody had heard. A closed verdict may be necessary, the story says, but no institution should mistake its own convenience for eternity.

Practice: memorial hearings let people amend an ancestor's official biography. Some temples host arbitration; others refuse legal power and teach critical inquiry. Debate is not required to end in consensus.

Disagreement: can a process remain open while people need a decision now? A judge can be sincere and wrong; a dissenter can be courageous and self-interested. Players have something to do besides choose obedience or nihilism.

Ancients: the Kinship Beyond Memory

Many Ancients communities distinguish an inherited account from the event itself. They honor people, places and powers that carried life through earlier changes. Some traditions use familial language, others ecology or astronomy. Their stories can make new knowledge sacred rather than threatening.

The First Traveler

Concern: departure, hospitality, migration and carrying relationships across change. **Sign:** a footstep beside a star, sometimes replaced by wheel marks or a pressure trail. **Offering:** a story brought home honestly, a berth given without owning its guest.

Story: the First Traveler reached every world but never found one that had no history before arrival. The original lesson may be humility, curiosity or the impossibility of beginning from nothing. Explorers still argue over which version preserves the oldest account.

Practice: an arriving guest may describe one place they left; hosts may offer the same in return. Adopted worlds and reconstructed bodies can be homes rather than betrayals. Pilgrimage can move outward instead of back to an origin.

Disagreement: what does a traveler owe the place they leave? A missing person's family and the person who deliberately departed may have valid incompatible wishes. Following a sacred route is an invitation to explore, not a mandate to claim its destinations.

The Remembering Sea

Concern: memory, loss, archives and the boundary between preservation and possession. **Sign:** several ripples that never become one line. **Offering:** a record returned with its context and the recorded person's wishes intact.

Story: the Sea remembers every voice but answers only with fragments because a complete life cannot be held by a listener who refuses to change. On Pelara the story is literal water; in a fleet it may be radio noise, shared song or a room of inherited instruments.

Practice: mourners share more than one account of the deceased, including disagreement if everyone involved agrees. An archive may reserve a place for retracted testimony. Privacy can be sacred, not an obstacle to collective memory.

Disagreement: who can release a dead person's records? A church, family, research sponsor and mechanical continuation may all have different claims. The story does not settle those claims automatically.

The Seed Beneath Ash

Concern: ecology, adaptation, survival and futures that cannot replicate the past. **Sign:** a seed beside a cracked shell; living symbols vary by habitat. **Offering:** a restored environment that someone can actually inhabit, not merely an immaculate exhibit.

Story: after a revered garden burned, the caretaker searched for its exact former shape. The Seed offered new growth that looked unfamiliar. Accepting it did not make the loss good; refusing it did not bring the old garden back.

Practice: communities tend living memorials, habitat repair projects or low-maintenance public gardens. Bioengineering can be holy work, contested work or ordinary work. No universal ban on technology follows from the tradition.

Disagreement: how much alteration counts as repair? Worlds and people are not property of the first person to describe them. An ecological expedition can reveal a new option without requiring the crew to solve every cultural dispute.

Divinity: the Companions of the Threshold

These traditions gather around transitions: illness and recovery, departure and return, revelation and doubt, continuity and death. A threshold can be crossed freely, refused, or guarded while someone else decides. Many believers hold that power is accountable to the person who bears its cost.

The Lantern at Dusk

Concern: public care, courageous visibility and companionship in uncertainty. **Sign:** a light with an unclosed shade; the point is that someone may approach. **Offering:** a refuge maintained, a warning made clear, a person accompanied without conditions.

Story: the Lantern could not make night disappear, so it stayed where the next frightened traveler could see it. The story's promise is presence, not invulnerability. Some communities treat the Lantern as a person, others a sacred office that many have held.

Practice: public meals, night watches, recovery celebrations and straightforward labels on dangerous rites. A religious rescuer can offer help without requiring the rescued person's participation.

Disagreement: what should remain visible when publicity puts someone at risk? Lantern and Veil communities often cooperate: accountable care may require private shelter.

The Listener Between Stars

Concern: attention, consent, solitude and communication across difference. **Sign:** two separated points with an open space between them. **Offering:** hearing an answer without taking ownership of it; keeping a confidence; asking before reaching into another mind.

Story: the Listener heard every distress cry and learned that answering in one's own voice was not the same as hearing another. The silence between stars became a place where a reply could be chosen rather than extracted.

Practice: quiet rooms open to believers and nonbelievers, psionic consent protocols, translated testimony and visits that permit silence. Secular psionic schools may use the same good practices without worship.

Disagreement: can an emergency justify an intrusion, and who later judges that claim? Treat this as a serious ethical situation with alternatives and consequences, never a surprise license to seize a PC's thoughts.

The Keeper of the Last Door

Concern: endings, continuity, grief, transformation and the right to refuse a promised escape. **Sign:** a door drawn from both sides; neither side is marked superior. **Offering:** honoring a documented wish, accompanying someone through change, refusing to sell certainty about death.

Story: the Keeper was offered a power that would ensure nobody ever left. Instead the Keeper made a door that could open and could remain closed. Traditions disagree over what lies beyond it. Some communities believe in an afterlife, some in continuity through others, and some refuse to decide.

Practice: advance wishes recorded by the person, remembrance services, careful rites around reconstruction, and support for those who choose no transformation. Mechanical humans are persons, not theological puzzles whose identity the Guide can revoke.

Disagreement: which promises survive a transfer or duplication? The doctrine does not make one medical treatment holy and another inherently corrupt. It provides characters with questions, relationships and institutions to visit.

Making religion playable

When a sacred place enters an adventure, prepare a welcoming person, a useful ordinary service, an internal disagreement and a discoverable story. Include what people do when nothing is on fire. A temple can provide medicine or information without becoming a puzzle gate.

Choose a divine figure as a patron story if desired. It gives **no second numerical package** beyond Pantheon, Mantle and rites. A character can change which figure matters without losing abilities. A supposed omen should have an observable form; the Guide describes it and lets the character interpret it. Gods do not automatically resolve missions, dictate PC beliefs or convert a world because someone rolled well.

Nine adventure invitations

Figure	Invitation	Practical conflict
Cartographer of Returns	Return an erased transit map	Publishing it opens rescue access and a smuggling route
Joined Hand	Carry a repair expert to a failing habitat	The expert's employer claims ownership of the repair method
Unfinished Judge	Recover testimony from a sealed archive	A witness wants privacy and an innocent person needs an appeal
First Traveler	Follow a pilgrimage whose last stop moved	The destination is a migrating community, not a fixed ruin
Remembering Sea	Escort a memory collection	Its legal owner and its recorded subjects disagree
Seed Beneath Ash	Survey unfamiliar growth after a disaster	Restoration can help residents or displace them
Lantern at Dusk	Reopen a refuge on an unsafe route	Keeping it supplied requires a real expedition
Listener Between Stars	Investigate a shared distress impression	People disagree on consent to further contact
Keeper of the Last Door	Deliver a person's documented final wishes	A sponsor promises a transformation the person refused

Play aids / Six ready explorers

All six are new tabletop characters, not additions to established story canon. Every character starts rank 1, Guard 6, Strain 0/4, Conviction 2/3, light armor (once/scene reduce one hit by 1), a damage-2 weapon, communicator and sealed excursion suit. Group pools: Supply 4/8, Accord 2/3. Starting ship: Courier, Hull 8/8, Stores 4/6, 2 cargo slots, Sanctuary berth module. Read affinity/rites in chapter 2 and techniques in chapter 8. Each has one Provenance contact and one Pantheon Aspect contact, usable separately under their respective rules. All Lineages and Embodiments below use chapter 5 rules.

Taren Vale

Order / Dissenter · Foundry-Raised · Bulwark

Human / Augmented: integrated communicator, usable hands-free; second expertise Watchfulness. Starting technique: Clear the Way. Personal thread: find the rescue crew that rebuilt your damaged arm; they vanished after their last transit.

Force +2, Finesse 0, Insight +1, Presence +1. Expertise: Machinery. Close weapon, shield, light armor. First talent: once/round intercept an attack against a willing ally in your zone, then roll defense yourself. Shield is descriptive equipment; it adds no unlisted defense bonus.

Affinity: Prepared Ground. Rites: Bastion; Measure the Fault. Mechanic contact: Elis, a repairer willing to fix an ordinary device in an hour. Aspect contact: a local reform circle, once/adventure shelter or truthful lead where present.

Creed: “I will keep people safe, even when that costs my position; I will never make shelter conditional on worship.” Protect: a younger sibling employed by a gate authority. Doubt: perhaps transparent control is still control. Items: work badge, spare gloves, sibling's letter.

At the crossing you recognize the sound of a brace bearing too much load. This is a useful observation, not automatic discovery of every fault.

Neri Ash

Ancients / Wanderer · Road-Bound · Wayrunner

Human / Unmodified: once/session identify a reachable practical alternative after a failed attempt; second expertise Spacecraft. Starting technique: Pathfinder. Personal thread: recover the route recorder of a missing courier. Your upbringing was aboard a mixed-faith transport, not an entire species' culture.

Force +1, Finesse +2, Insight +1, Presence 0. Expertise: Routes. Ranged weapon, rope, light armor. First talent: once/scene move one extra zone for free during your turn.

Affinity: Wayfinding. Rites: Living Path; Star Witness. Courier contact: Oren, knows a safe route and what it costs. Aspect contact: an ordinary waystation, once/adventure shelter or truthful lead where present.

Creed: “I will finish the route, even when the sender lies; I will never abandon someone merely because they slow me.” Protect: a fellow courier who disappeared after refusing a delivery. Doubt: finishing the wrong task can be worse than failure. Items: route notebook, oilskin, empty locket.

You carry the medicine at the beginning unless another player volunteers. The consignment is a responsibility, not your property.

Esra Pell

Divinity / Lantern · Sanctuary-Kept · Envoy

Human / Mechanical Continuant: one watch vacuum survival, repair/medical tools both support personal recovery; second expertise Records. Starting technique: Read the Room. Personal thread: reconcile your continuity record with a promise made before reconstruction; your identity belongs to you, not the registrar.

Force 0, Finesse +1, Insight +1, Presence +2. Expertise: Care. Close weapon, credentials, light armor. First talent: once/scene ask a speaking NPC what concession would earn a ceasefire; receive an honest current answer, possibly "none."

Affinity: Shared Breath. Rites: Sanctuary; Unmask. Attendant contact: Fen, can provide shelter for one recovery. Aspect contact: a public refuge, once/adventure shelter or truthful lead where present.

Creed: "I will listen before I judge, even when fear makes certainty easier; I will never trade another person's consent for my own safety." Protect: a sanctuary that accepts doubters. Doubt: you have mistaken relief for justice before. Items: clean bandages, admission ledger, chipped cup.

At the crossing you understand why people want a functioning authority and why they fear signing the pledge. You do not begin knowing which bargain they should accept.

Cal Ren

Order / Architect · Archive-Taught · Artificer

Human / Gene-Crafted: once/scene ignore 1 poison/radiation/biological-contamination damage; second expertise Machinery. Starting technique: Field Hack. Personal thread: locate the stolen patient-consent archive of your clinic. Religion, technical training and engineered biology are independent parts of your life.

Force +1, Finesse 0, Insight +2, Presence +1. Expertise: Records. Close weapon, tools, light armor. First talent: once/scene spend an action to restore 2 Guard to a conscious ally in your zone.

Affinity: Prepared Ground. Rites: Bastion; Measure the Fault. Clerk contact: Jun, can obtain an ordinary local record. Aspect contact: a modest workshop, once/adventure shelter or truthful lead where present.

Creed: "I will make the record accessible, even when it condemns my work; I will never alter evidence to protect a patron." Protect: an apprentice taught to trust official forms. Doubt: accurate records do not guarantee anyone will act. Items: carbon paper, measuring cord, annotated repair manual.

You volunteered to certify the delivery. Whether you certify the crossing is another question.

Rell Tal

Ancients / Keeper · Void-Born · Witness

Veyran / Psionically Attuned: Echo Sense detects movement through a shared surface in your zone; once/scene exchange a brief willing thought with someone in your/adjacent visible zone. Neither reads minds or substitutes for interstellar communications.

Force 0, Finesse +1, Insight +2, Presence +1. Expertise: Spacecraft. Ranged weapon, recording kit, light armor. Starting talent: once/scene identify a visible contradiction in available physical evidence. Starting technique: Trace. Affinity: Wayfinding. Rites: Living Path, Star Witness.

Creed: "I will preserve a person's account, even when it challenges mine; I will never sell a private memory without consent." Provenance contact: Jori, a deckhand who can provide routine dock access or an ordinary ship component.

Aspect contact: a habitat caretaker, shelter or truthful lead once/adventure. Personal thread: find the origin of a route chart that records a world you remember but cannot name. Items: family recording, marking chalk, preserved tea.

Ora Sen

Divinity / Threshold · Border-Forged · Votary

Oruun / Unmodified: once/scene react to ignore human-scale forced movement, still taking damage; once/session identify a reachable practical alternative after a failed attempt.

Force +1, Finesse 0, Insight +1, Presence +2. Expertise: Watchfulness. Close weapon, focus, light armor. Starting talent: once/scene regain 1 Conviction after paying for and resolving a rite. Starting technique: Ritual Literacy. Affinity: Shared Breath. Rites: Sanctuary, Unmask.

Creed: “I will give people a way home, even when the journey frightens me; I will never claim certainty I do not have.” Provenance contact: Den, a scout who can reveal the nearest immediate threat. Aspect contact: a discreet messenger, shelter or truthful lead once/adventure. Personal thread: learn why a refugee ship stopped one leg short of its destination. Items: voyage ribbon, carved cup, broken transmitter.

Shared opening bond

For **The Silent Berth**, all characters helped the same rescue ship during a port emergency. Its captain arranged their current Courier's loan and introduced them as a competent crew. They need paid work and each has a reason to keep traveling. Pick one person they all trust at Meridian Anchorage. No NPC commands their decisions.

For **The Unclaimed Crossing**, they once helped the same household recover after a route closure; that household pooled money for the medicine delivery. Their ship is safely berthed elsewhere. The group trusts one another's competence and agrees the consignment reaches people who need it. Neri carries it unless someone else volunteers. References in the character hooks to a crossing apply only to this optional groundside adventure.

Choose any 2-4 from the six, or create your own. For duet select any one and use a companion from chapter 3. A Guide can provide a missing practical skill through tools, a contact or cooperation; never require one specific Vocation to advance. Rank 2 Discipline choices are deliberately left to players. The four human characters demonstrate different bodies and beliefs within one species, not separate human “races.”

Play aids / Worked examples

These are invented demonstrations of the written rules, not transcripts of playtests. Dice are selected to show a decision. The full feature text governs when a summary omits a prerequisite.

A discovery without a required class

The crew finds a sealed seed case in a greenhouse. The Guide gives the obvious evidence without a roll: its maker's mark, an intact latch and frost inside. Cal, a gene-crafted human Artificer, wants to open it. Neri, an unmodified human Wayrunner, wants to identify its owner first. Neither approach requires a particular body, species or faith.

Neri asks a reachable courier contact about the maker's mark. Ordinary information within that person's experience is conversation. A Provenance contact's guaranteed once/adventure service is its listed service, not unlimited answers to unrelated questions. Here the courier knows only where such cases are delivered. That opens a lead; it does not identify everything inside.

Cal then examines the damaged temperature control under pressure from a spreading coolant leak. The Guide declares an Insight/Machinery task, four progress, with these stakes: partial gives one progress safely or two with 1 Strain; failure fills no progress and advances the announced leak countdown. Cal rolls dice 2 and 3, adds Insight +2 and Machinery +1: total 8. He chooses two progress and 1 Strain. The Guide describes a readable shipping date. A later success can finish the task; the same roll doesn't also open a different locked door.

The discovery can lead to science, trade, a religious observance, a personal quest or several together. A ritual interpretation needs evidence and people who hold it. It isn't the automatic answer to every artifact.

One personal combat round

Two PCs face a Rifle Guard and a close-range attacker. The crew opens round 1. Neri moves into the guard's zone and fires her ordinary carbine. Being Void-Born wouldn't add Spacecraft to this weapon strike. Her dice 2 and 3 plus Finesse +2 total 7. She deals 2 damage and chooses exposure rather than 1 Strain.

The Guide activates the damaged guard. It attacks Neri for listed damage 2. She rolls defense 3 and 3 plus Finesse +2: total 8. Exposure makes the incoming hit 3. She chooses half plus 1 Strain: round 3/2 up to 2, then spends her unused light armor to reduce it to 1. With no other protection or temporary Guard, she loses 1 Guard. Exposure is consumed; light armor is spent for this scene. The guard doesn't also get a free counterattack from her earlier partial.

The second PC, Taren, moves to an objective and uses his action there. Then the close attacker takes its activation. Round 1 ends after everyone has acted; enemies open round 2. There is no opportunity attack merely because Taren moved between zones.

If Neri had fully avoided the guard's attack, exposure would remain until its expiry. If armor reduced a successful hit to zero, exposure would still be consumed. Protection changes the damage, not the number of enemy actions.

A Witness changes the outcome

At rank 3, a Witness watches an ally repair a falling lift. The ally's dice sum to 6; Insight +2 and Machinery +1 make 9. No other edge or hindrance applies. Before resolving the outcome, the Witness uses their once/scene rank-3 talent to grant an edge. Net situation becomes +1, total 10: full success. The Witness needs no additional action for this explicitly timed talent.

If the ally already had a net +1 situation, another edge wouldn't make it +2. If the crew spends Accord, reroll both dice and keep the new result with the same committed attribute, expertise and legal net situation. It is one action, and the Witness talent remains spent. An ordinary before-roll Conviction edge cannot be bought after seeing the dice.

In the companion, use the after-roll situation control only when a feature authorizes it. It adjusts a tracked result; it doesn't decide whether the feature was available.

Overreach, interruption and a refund

Esra is a Divinity character with Conviction 2, Strain 1 and Guard 5. She declares Radiant Debt with overreach to affect two visible legal enemies. First spend 1 Conviction. Radiant Debt adds 1 activation Strain, then overreach adds 2: Strain reaches 4. Resolve Fracture before rolling.

If Esra chooses withdrawal, reset Strain to 1 and interrupt the rite. Both costs remain spent, no attack resolves, and she cannot act or react until the end of her next turn; she may move toward safety on that turn. If she instead loses 2 Guard, Guard becomes 3 and Strain resets to 1; she can continue. Now roll the rite. A partial would affect both targets and add the separate hostile-rite result Strain. Overreach does not grant a second action.

Consider a different caster: a Votary using an ordinary cost-1 rite with exactly 1 Conviction available. They can pay it, resolve the rite, then use their available once/scene talent to regain 1 Conviction. They cannot start with 0 and promise to pay from that later refund. A Hierophant's optional partial-result substitution also needs its additional Conviction before the later refund.

Stabilization and returning to the scene

A rank-3 character has base maximum Guard 7 and no wounds. An attack reduces them to Guard 0. They become Downed and cannot activate. An ally reaches the same zone and spends an action stabilizing them before a following round's wound accrues. Stabilization gives one wound, so wounded maximum Guard is now 6. They remain at Guard 0.

An ordinary ampoule, Renewal or Tissue Knit cannot revive them. After immediate danger, a paid Recovery restores 3 Guard, lowers Strain by 2 and brings Conviction to at least 2. The wound remains. The group's 1 Supply pays for everyone's eligible Recovery, not 1 per person.

A master Biotic with Life Bridge could instead spend its session use, action, 1 Supply and 1 Strain to restore 2 Guard to this stabilized target during danger. They can act on their next eligible activation, not take an immediate bonus turn. A target retired at three wounds needs care and an agreed return; Life Bridge doesn't bypass that condition.

Two people operate a ship

Two PCs in a Courier face a patrol cutter at Engagement 2. The Courier is Hull 8, Stores 3 with a functioning Sanctuary berth. One PC uses Brace automatically; the other tries to Maneuver away. The maneuver dice plus Finesse total 8. Success decreases Engagement to 1; using the Courier's available once/scene trait could decrease it by 2 instead, reaching 0. They take the declared partial cost, either 1 Hull or 1 Stores. They cannot also fire using that same action.

Suppose they choose the ordinary change to 1 and spend Stores, leaving 2. Now the cutter gets its one action. It attempts to close to Engagement 2. The pilot may allow that shift or roll to resist it. Suppose the pilot rolls 10 and prevents the closure: Engagement remains 1. The cutter cannot also fire. Next round both PCs choose new station actions. The previous Brace reduces the next enemy hit, so record it until that hit rather than inventing an extra automatic cost.

On a later cutter attack for 3 damage, the chosen pilot rolls a defense total 8. They may take full damage, or half rounded up (2) plus System Damage to an operational installed module. They choose the latter and mark Sanctuary berth disabled.

If Brace is still available it reduces the 2 Hull damage to 0; the module is still disabled. The marker is not another lost Hull point. Ordinary repair can restore the berth later with its own watch and Supply.

For escape, consider the Courier's alternate first-round choice: use its trait to reach Engagement 0. The cutter attempts to close to 1 with its action. The pilot resists with total 8 and spends 1 Stores to keep separation. On round 2, a successful Maneuver at 0 can depart, paying the normal partial cost if necessary. Failure would deal ordinary 1 Hull damage and give the cutter another action to pursue. The crew cannot spend two station Maneuvers in that round to undo the failed attempt. A Surveyor or Hauler can use the same procedure after reducing range one step at a time; the pursuer's range changes are still contested.

At a safe destination the crew can negotiate, repair and take another job. This is space adventure even if no Zeal or territorial rules are used.

A pushed action is not a bigger dice modifier

A rank-1 explorer with Force +2 and Strain 2 declares a damage Push on a damage-2 close strike. Pay 1 Strain first, reaching 3. Dice 3 and 4 produce total 9. Deal damage 3 before armor, then choose the normal strike partial cost: exposure or 1 result Strain. If choosing Strain, the hit has already resolved when Fracture occurs. Losing Guard or withdrawing does not erase that resolved hit.

If the explorer instead began at Strain 3, Push would trigger Fracture before rolling. Withdrawal interrupts the unresolved strike with the cost spent. Losing 2 Guard permits the roll only if still able. Other activation Strain, such as overreach, joins the Push payment as one packet; do not resolve the Push point separately to obtain a more favorable reset.

An Accord reroll replaces the same dice for the same prepared action. It does not pay another Push point, create another hit or grant its damage twice. Ordinary defense, healing and automatic relic activations cannot be Pushed. See the turning-point walkthrough for a selected-dice expedition ledger including a wonder, a Creed cost and Recovery.

Lookup during play

Decision	Read
Which dice, outcome or partial cost?	Core rules: Resolution and Action and trigger order
Does a feature use my action or reaction?	Its full text; ordinary default is one move/action, one supplied reaction per round
How much damage reaches Guard?	Core rules: Damage order
Can a character act after harm?	Core rules: Harm and Strain; explicit revival features
Does a power refresh?	Core rules: Time and refresh limits
Is this personal or ship combat?	Core rules: Tactical scenes; chapter 6: Ship encounters
Can an unfamiliar character build work?	Chapters 5, 8, 9 and 12; identity packages remain independent
What should a new Guide prepare?	Guide preparation and the chosen adventure; write visible stakes before rolling

Play aids / Table reference and sheet

A roll

2d6 + attribute + one relevant expertise (+1) + net situation (-1, 0 or +1).

6- fail and consequence; 7-9 succeed with cost/reduced effect; 10-11 succeed; 12+ succeed plus +1 damage/progress, avoid immediate hazard, or next ally edge. No NPC attack rolls. No repeat without changed approach. Spend 1 Accord after a roll to reroll both dice once; keep new roll.

A round

Alternate one crew activation and one enemy activation. Crew opens round 1 unless ambushed; opening side alternates afterward. Each unit activates once; a side with units left finishes after the other exhausts activations. Turn = move one zone + one action. Sprint spends action for another move. One granted reaction per round. Close reaches own zone; ranged own/adjacent visible zone. Help gives an edge. Taking cover uses an action, gives ranged defense edge until moving/attacking. Objective task clocks: 7-9 fills 1; 10-11 fills 2; 12+ fills 3 (already includes exceptional progress); 6- none and consequence.

PC attack: Force close / Finesse ranged, without generic expertise bonus. Damage 2 ordinary; on 7-9 take 1 Strain or exposure (+1 next enemy hit before your next turn). Miss: no damage, +1 Strain. NPC in cover gives ranged attacker a hindrance. Armor subtracts rating, minimum 1 from a positive damaging hit; limited reductions can then bring it to 0. Temporary Guard absorbs damage before Guard. Light armor reduces one hit by 1 once/scene.

Push before rolling: +1 activation Strain for +1 damage to one target OR +1 task progress on success. One/action; no dice bonus. Sum with all other activation Strain before Fracture. Interruption spends costs; an Accord reroll keeps the same Push. Not defense, healing, automatic effects or ship actions. Pushed task progress: 2/3/4; choosing a different exceptional benefit instead means 3 progress.

Enemy attack: target rolls Force/Finesse. 6- full damage; 7-9 full damage OR half rounded up +1 Strain; 10+ none; 12+ also move one zone or ally edge. No counterattack granted by a failed PC strike.

Rite: action +1 Conviction; hostile roll Presence unless specified. 7-9 effect +1 Strain; 6- no effect +1 Strain. Friendly rites automatic unless externally endangered. Overreach +2 Strain for +1 zone range or second legal target; resolve Fracture before casting.

Guard 0: Downed. Ally stabilizes as action; gain one wound on stabilization. Unstabilized: one wound at end of each following round. Three wounds from any cause: retire from scene; agree capture/disability/death with player. Wounds reduce max Guard 1 each, minimum max 3. One full safe day +1 Supply heals one wound.

Strain 4: reset to 1; withdraw through next turn or lose 2 Guard. Recovery once/scene after danger: 10 min +1 group Supply; everyone +3 Guard, -2 Strain, Conviction to at least 2. Safe night's rest restores Guard, clears Strain, Conviction to at least 2. Neither removes wounds or refills Accord. Each session begins with at least 2 Accord; one shared recovery/session from risky rescue, negotiated sacrifice or a crew scene about a new joint risk/discovery restores 1, maximum 3. These share one limit.

Character and crew sheet

EXPLORER DOSSIER

LANTERN REACH / FIELD RECORD

NAME / PLAYER

PANTHEON / ASPECT / MANTLE

LINEAGE / EMBODIMENT / CHOSEN FEATURE

PROVENANCE / HOMEWORLD / EXPERTISE

VOCATION / DISCIPLINE / RANK / MILESTONES

WEAPON / REACH / DAMAGE / ARMOR USE

FORCE	FINESSE	INSIGHT	PRESENCE
+ _____	+ _____	+ _____	+ _____

GUARD CURRENT / MAX STRAIN / 4 CONVICTION / 3 WOUNDS / 3 TEMPORARY GUARD

AFFINITY / TALENTS / TECHNIQUES

KNOWN RITES / COSTS / LIMITED USES

CREED: I WILL ... EVEN WHEN ...; I WILL NEVER ... CLAIM USED THIS SCENE [ ]

PATRON / PROTECTED PERSON / DOUBT / PERSONAL QUEST

GEAR / WEAPON FITTING / FIELD FITTING / TWO RELICS

CONTACTS / FACTION / TRUST / OBLIGATIONS

CREW / SHIP / HULL / STORES / SUPPLY / ACCORD OBSERVANCE USED THIS EXPEDITION [ ]

OPTIONAL TERRITORY: SITE / INFLUENCE BY FACTION / GRIEVANCE / PROJECT / UPKEEP

Play aids / Ship reference

Use chapter 6 for full rules; this sheet summarizes them.

Departure and return

Start Stores 4/6. Each leg costs 1 Stores; an interstellar passage is two legs. At a supplier, 1 Supply buys 1 Stores. At Stores 0 take a reachable rescue/debt/local job rather than inventing free long-range travel. Normal known-route flight needs no roll. A watch is four hours. Routine safe rest is separate from a downtime project.

At a safe port, one watch +1 Supply restores 3 Hull **or** one System Damage. Hull 0 requires dockyard, one day and 2 Supply to restore Hull 3 first. A mission ordinarily pays 3-4 Supply or clearly specified goods. Spend surplus reward on purchases before applying Supply cap 8.

Ship round

Each PC takes one station action, then the enemy ship/group takes one action. This differs from alternating personal activations. Most ships start with one gun station, so only one Fire per crew round; second-weapon module allows two.

Engagement: **0 separated -> 1 sensors -> 2 weapons -> 3 docking**. Maneuver once/crew round can change it. At 0, a successful later Maneuver aligns departure and escapes, paying normal costs. Resist an enemy's one-step range change with pilot Finesse/Insight +Spacecraft: 6- shift happens; 7-9 allow it or prevent for 1 Stores/1 Hull; 10+ prevent; 12+ also change range by 1. This defense doesn't spend a station action. At 3 boarding needs a route and docking task, then personal scenes.

Station	Quick rule
Maneuver	Finesse/Insight: 7+ change Engagement 1; partial take 1 Hull or pay 1 Stores; miss no change +1 Hull damage
Fire	Finesse at Engagement 2-3: hit 2 Hull; partial/miss gunner +1 Strain; exceptional +1 damage or other normal benefit
Scan	Insight: reveal Hull, weapon and vulnerability/clue; partial reveals your signature; miss next enemy shot ignores Brace
Brace / Repair	Once/crew round: reduce next enemy hit 2, **or** spend 1 Stores to repair 2 Hull, automatic; no combat repair of Hull 0
Hail	Concrete negotiation; roll Presence only if uncertain
Help	Give another station operator an edge; situation cap still applies

Enemy either shifts Engagement 1, fires at 2-3, boards at 3, or works an announced objective. Enemy fire: pilot defense Finesse +applicable expertise. Miss full listed damage; partial full damage **or** half rounded up plus one operational module disabled; success none; exceptional also shift Engagement 1. Brace reduces main hit only. If no operational module exists choose full damage. A raider group gets one shared turn.

Hull 0: disabled, **4-round emergency countdown** and **4-progress Stabilization task**. Crew acts each round to stabilize/evacuate; success saves life support but needs tow. Countdown expiry leads to pods/rescue/capture, not mandatory death.

Personal excursion

Sealed suit lasts one watch; safe refuge recharges it free. Emergency field renewal costs 1 Supply for all suits. A breach gives one full turn to patch or reach safety, then 2 Guard damage each round end until protected. Mechanical Continuant can survive one watch without a suit but still suffers weapons, radiation and impact. Tools and rites do not make alien air safe without evidence.

Record objective, reward, route, known hazard, three discoveries, two risks and one person with a need. Give physical clues freely; roll for dangerous access or interpretation, not whether an essential clue exists. A mission can finish without combat, religious activity, or Zeal.